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THE PHONE-FIRST EDITION

09

The Online Service Business

10 Zero-to-Low-Cost Services You Can Sell to Local Businesses

Pick one service, package it, price it, and turn one client into a business.

10 services | Pricing models | Outreach scripts

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The Online Service Business

10 Zero-to-Low-Cost Services You Can Sell to Local Businesses

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Read This Before You Pick a Service

The local Online Service Business — 10 Zero-to-Low-Cost Services You Can Sell to Local Businesses. First Edition · September 2026.

Publisher: NexKit your country Editorial Team. This course was researched, written and edited by the NexKit your country Editorial Team. It carries no individual author name and no personal credentials, because the value of the book is the method, not a personality.

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What this course is

A practical, your country-specific manual for turning one digital skill into a small service business that local businesses pay for month after month. It covers ten services, and for every one it tells you who buys it, the problem it solves, the beginner skill you need, the free tools, a sample offer, sample pricing in dollars, how to find clients, an outreach script, the delivery workflow, the upsell and the recurring-revenue path.

What this course is not

It is not a promise of clients or income. It is not a list of real local companies you can approach as customers, because every business in this book is invented. It does not guarantee that any particular local business will pay for any particular service, and it is not legal, tax or financial advice. More than eighty per cent of federal business licences issued where you live went dormant during 2025, so client churn is a real planning assumption, not a warning.

DISCLAIMER — READ THIS ONCE, PROPERLY

This course is **educational material only**. Nothing in it is a guarantee of income, and nothing in it is financial, legal or investment advice.

Every price in this book is an **example for teaching, not a market rate**. your country has no published rate card for these services, so the honest method is to ask local businesses what they currently pay, then price from your own hours and the value you create. Your first price will probably be wrong; the course shows you how to correct it after three clients.

All prices, rates and ladders shown in this book are **illustrative examples** for teaching. You are responsible for complying with local law, your tax obligations, the terms of service of any platform you use, and the requirements of any bank, wallet or payment provider you deal with. Rules, fees, limits and country availability change, sometimes quickly.

Where the underlying research could not verify a fact, this book says so and tells you to check it yourself. Those gaps were left as gaps deliberately.

DATES, CURRENCY AND EXAMPLES

All money in this course is US US dollars (USD), written as $25. Where a United States dollar figure appears it states its rate and its date on the same line.

Every business named anywhere in these pages is invented. Each is labelled **Example scenario — fictional**. No real, recognisable local company is presented as a client, a case study or a testimonial.

Every figure cited is current as of **September 2026** unless a different date is printed beside it. Source URLs for those figures appear in the **Sources & Further Reading** section at the back of the book.

BEFORE YOU RELY ON ANY OF THIS

Payment limits, wallet rules, tax thresholds and platform availability are the parts of this book most likely to go stale. Treat every number as a starting point for your own check, not as a substitute for it. Where this book names a rule, confirm the current version with the institution that made it.

1. Google Business Profile \u2014 supported countries — `https://support.google.com/business/answer/6270107`

Last updated: September 2026. Questions or corrections: use the contact address supplied with your purchase.

What is inside this course

01 · The Service-Business Model, and Why It Beats Gig Work 11
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HOW TO WORK THROUGH THIS COURSE

Skim the section dividers first so you can see the whole route. Then work one section at a time and finish the **DO** tasks before moving to the next. The scripts, templates and checklists are meant to be copied, filled in and sent — not admired.

FRONT MATTER

Before You Start

This course teaches one thing: how to turn a digital skill you have, or can learn in a few weeks, into a small service business that local small local businesses pay for again and again.

What this course can help you do

— Understand the difference between a one-off job, a package and a monthly retainer, and why the third one is the only version that behaves like a business.

— Choose your first service from ten options using a scoring sheet instead of a feeling.

— Write a complete offer, a price ladder in dollars and an outreach message for whichever service you pick.

— Find real prospects on Google Maps, a local classifieds site, the online business directory and the online business directory without buying a lead list.

— Run a client conversation the way local business owners actually make decisions, including the deposit question and the "come back next week" answer.

— Deliver the work, invoice it, collect it through a wallet or bank transfer, and keep a client file that makes month two faster than month one.

— Know exactly where the legal line sits: what an individual with no licence can and cannot do about payments, tax and registration.

— Finish a thirty-day plan at about ninety minutes a day, ending with a portfolio, a price list and a real list of businesses you have approached.

What this course cannot do

It cannot get you clients, and it cannot promise an income, a reply rate or a timeline. It cannot tell you what these services cost in your city, because **no published local rate card for this kind of work could be verified when this course was written**. Every price in this book is a teaching example, not a market rate. It also cannot promise that the business you approach will still be trading next month, because most local small businesses are not durable advertisers, and the honest market picture later in this front matter explains what that means for your planning.

What the course can do is remove the guesswork: you will know what to sell, who buys it, what to say, what to charge as a starting example, how to deliver it, and how to get paid legally.

What you need

ITEM	WHY YOU NEED IT	HONEST NOTE
An Android phone	Almost every service in this book is delivered from a phone	This is the minimum. A phone alone is a real starting point.
A data bundle	Messages, uploads, client files, research	A 2 GB monthly bundle is around $0.60 on an indicative published guide, and prices change often. Check your own operator.

ITEM	WHY YOU NEED IT	HONEST NOTE
A Google account	Drive folders for delivery, Sheets for your prospect list, Maps for prospecting, Business Profile for one of the ten services	Free. Keep client files inside your own Drive, not your personal photo gallery.

ITEM	WHY YOU NEED IT	HONEST NOTE
A free design tool with templates	Posts, price lists, simple brand assets	Canva is the one most readers already have. Free plans change, so check the current limits yourself before you build a workflow on it.

ITEM	WHY YOU NEED IT	HONEST NOTE
A free video editor	Short-form video, which is service number three	CapCut, InShot and VN Editor are all live on the Play Store and all have usable free paths. InShot lets you watch an advert to remove the watermark.
A free AI chat tool, where available	Drafting messages, summarising a client's own text, rewriting in plain English	Optional. Never paste a client's private documents or customer lists into a tool you do not trust.
A wallet or bank account in your own name	Getting paid	a mobile wallet, a mobile-money wallet, a mobile wallet, a bank wallet and similar licensed wallets all work for a person with no business licence. Limits are in Section 09.
A laptop, sometimes	Website setup and long documents are genuinely better on one	Not required to start. Section 09 and the service chapters say exactly where a laptop stops being optional.

Bundle prices are indicative and change often. Free plans change too. Verify the current limits of every tool before you build a paid workflow on it.

Time you actually need

Plan for **about ninety minutes a day for thirty days**. That is the honest figure, not a motivational one. Sections 01 to 03 are reading and deciding; Sections 04 to 08 are the service you chose; Section 09 is the money and paperwork; Section 10 is the thirty-day plan itself. If your day collapses, do the smallest task in the plan and keep the streak.

If ninety minutes a day is unrealistic for you right now, the five-hour fast path later in this front matter gets you to a first approach without the full build.

THE MOST IMPORTANT RULE

Sell one service until it works. Then add a second.

The most common way a beginner service business dies is not laziness and it is not competition. It dies because the owner offered social-media management, design, video editing, website setup and "anything digital" in the same month, and became forgettable at all five.

One service means one offer to describe, one price to defend, one delivery checklist to improve, one type of client to find, and one set of samples to show. When a prospect asks what you do, the answer is one sentence, not a list.

Add a second service only after you have **at least one client who has paid you in two different months**, or three separate clients who have paid once each. That is the evidence that the first service works. Until then, a second service is a way of avoiding the harder work of finding clients for the first one.

FRONT MATTER

Who This Is For, and Who It Is Not For

This is for you if

- You are roughly 20 to 35, in your city or in a regional city, a regional city, a regional city, a regional city, a regional city, a regional city, a regional city, a smaller town, a smaller town or a smaller town.
- You have one digital skill, or you are willing to spend two to six weeks learning one properly.
- You want a repeatable small business serving local businesses, not a pile of one-off gigs.
- You have no business licence, no office, no employees and little or no capital, and you are not pretending otherwise.
- You can send messages to strangers and treat silence as information rather than rejection.
- You are willing to do unglamorous work: correcting a Google Maps listing, photographing thirty products, rewriting a price list.

This is not for you if

- You want income this week. The first thirty days are for building the offer and starting conversations.
- You want passive income. Every service here is paid work. It stops when you stop.
- You plan to earn from platform advert revenue. your country is not on YouTube's monetisation availability list and is not included in Meta's in-stream ads rollout, so ad-share is not a plan.
- You want to sell internationally as a first step, or you are looking for a way around local payment rules. Section 09 explains what is verified and what is not, and this course will not teach you to fake your country or rent an account.
- You are looking for a script that talks a business owner into something they do not need. Nothing here works on a client who does not understand what they are buying.

COURSE OBJECTIVES

By the end of this course you should be able to: describe the difference between a job, a package and a retainer and price all three; pick one of ten services with a written reason; produce a complete offer, a three-step price ladder and an outreach script for that service; build a prospect list of local businesses from free directories; run a first meeting, ask for a deposit without damaging the relationship, and follow up three times without pestering; deliver the service on a repeatable workflow; collect payment legally as an individual; and know the three numbers to track every month.

FRONT MATTER

If You Only Have Five Hours

This is the compressed path. It does not build a business. It gets you one honest approach to one real business, which is the only thing that tells you whether you want to continue.

TIME	WHAT YOU DO	WHAT YOU HAVE AT THE END
Hour 1	Read Section 03 only. Score the ten services on the opportunity sheet in Section 01 with six criteria. Pick the highest scorer you could start this week.	One chosen service and a written reason.
Hour 2	Read that service's chapter in Sections 04 to 08. Copy its sample offer and its outreach script into your notes app.	One offer you can describe in one sentence, and one message you can send.
Hour 3	Open Google Maps. Search your city plus your client type. Open the first twenty results. Write each into a Google Sheet with name, area, phone and one specific problem you can see.	A prospect list of twenty real businesses.
Hour 4	Send the outreach script to the ten best prospects, one at a time, edited so each message names the real problem you found. No copy-paste blasting.	Ten live conversations started.
Hour 5	Make one sample of the work, labelled clearly as a sample, so you have something to show when someone replies. Save it in a Drive folder with view access on.	One piece of proof and a link you can send.

Five hours gets you to a first approach. It does not replace the thirty-day plan, and it does not guarantee a reply from any of the ten businesses.

WHAT THE FIVE-HOUR PATH DELIBERATELY SKIPS

It skips the scope document, the deposit conversation, the delivery checklist and the tax and payment sections. Do not take money from a client before you have read Section 09. A paid job you cannot deliver, or cannot invoice, is worse than no job.

FRONT MATTER

The Honest Market Picture

You are selling to local small businesses. Before you write a single message, understand three facts about that market. None of them are discouraging. All of them change how you plan.

1. Most small businesses are not durable advertisers

More than 80 per cent of federal business licences issued went dormant during 2025. Read that as a planning assumption, not a crisis. It means a share of the businesses you approach will stop trading, stop answering, or stop paying, and it is not because you did anything wrong. It means you should expect to keep finding new clients even after you have some, and you should not build your month around two clients. It also means you should prefer services that a business keeps paying for while it is alive, and never depend on a single client for most of your income.

2. Google Business Profile is officially supported where you live

your country appears on Google's official list of supported countries for Business Profile. That matters commercially: it means "help me get found on Google Maps" is a service you can genuinely deliver here, not a workaround. Support pages and features change, so **verify it in your own account before you promise it to a client**. Then build the offer around what you can actually do: claim and correct the listing, fix the category, add hours, add real photographs, answer questions, and keep it updated.

3. The audience is small, and that is the opportunity

your country has about 136 million people, of whom **29.5 million, or 21.7 per cent, are internet users**, and 107 million are offline. Social-media identities stand at **9.80 million, about 7.2 per cent of the population**. Instagram reach is about 1.55 million and LinkedIn has about 1.80 million members.

Those numbers do not describe a market where a local shop wins by going viral. They describe a market where most customers still walk in, ask a friend, or find a business on Maps. So what a local business actually needs from you is smaller and more valuable than fame: **look alive, be findable, and answer messages**. A café with ten honest photographs, correct opening hours and a reply within an hour is ahead of most of its street.

> **WHAT THIS MEANS FOR YOUR PRICING**
>
> You are not selling reach. You are selling the boring, repeatable things an owner cannot get to: keeping the page alive, keeping the listing correct, keeping the catalogue readable, answering the customer who messaged at nine at night. Those are monthly jobs, and monthly jobs are the whole point of this book.

FRONT MATTER

How to Read Every Price in This Book

Every price in this course is an **example for teaching**. None of them is a market rate.

> **WHY THERE IS NO RATE CARD HERE**
>
> No published local rate card for these services could be verified when this course was written. local job posts do not publish salaries either: they say "Attractive" or "Negotiable". So anyone who tells you with confidence what social-media management costs in your city is guessing. This book refuses to guess and label it a fact.

The method that replaces a rate card

1. **Ask what they already pay**

   Ask the owner what they currently spend on the closest thing they buy: a boost on a Facebook post, a printed banner, a person who runs the page, a freelance photographer. That number is your ceiling and your anchor.

2. **Price your own hours first**

   Decide what an hour of your work is worth to you this month, against the reality that an entry-level federal civil service job for a degree holder pays $70 a month. If your service takes eight hours a month, your floor is eight hours at your rate, and nothing below that is a business.

1. **Adjust for the size of the client**
   A single juice house and a 40-room guest house should not pay the same. Charge by the work the client creates, not by the effort you feel.
1. **Correct after three clients**
   Your first price will be wrong, usually too low. After three clients, look at how long delivery actually took and raise the price for the next one. Section 09 shows how to raise it without losing the client.

Money in this book is written as **$25** or $25. Targets are targets. Nothing here is a forecast, and nothing here is guaranteed.

FRONT MATTER

How to Use This Course

Phone-first, but not phone-only

Every workflow is written for a phone first, because that is what most readers have. Where a laptop genuinely changes the work, it is named.

Genuinely fine on a phone

- Social-media management, including scheduling and replies
- Design work: posts, price lists, simple flyers
- Short-form video editing with CapCut, InShot or VN Editor
- Claiming and correcting a Google Business Profile listing
- Photographing and loading product catalogues
- WhatsApp and Telegram support setup, writing, and client messages

Really wants a laptop

- Website setup, especially anything past a one-page site
- Typing long documents: company profiles, proposals, manuals
- Uploading large files of product photographs on a weak connection
- Reading and editing spreadsheets with more than about fifty rows
- Print-ready files that a printer will accept without argument

No laptop: use a friend's, a university computer room, or an internet café for one focused hour to do the laptop-only step and export the result back to your phone. One hour of café time is usually the cheapest cost in the whole job.

Low-data mode

- Read offline. This course is text-first on purpose so it opens on a weak connection.
- Do research in one sitting rather than all day. Mobile speeds where you live can fall as low as 98 Kb/s in the worst hours, and the worst hours are usually 16:00 to 24:00.
- Compress everything before you send it. A shop owner on a small bundle will not open a 40 MB file, and will not tell you why they went quiet.
- Keep a plain text file of your offer, prices and messages so you can paste without loading anything heavy.
- Export video at 720p unless the client has asked for more. It uploads faster and looks fine on a phone.

A backup plan for internet disruptions

your country has a documented history of shutdowns and slowdowns, including a nationwide block of Facebook, Telegram, TikTok and YouTube from February to July 2023, a regional shutdown in Amhara, and localised disruptions in Oromia. Freedom House rated your country 30 out of 100 on internet freedom in 2025. Plan for it rather than being surprised by it.

— Keep client phone numbers in your phone, not only inside an app.
— Agree with every client that the fallback channel is a phone call or SMS.
— Queue work offline and upload when the connection returns.
— Deliver drafts in person when a deadline is close and the network is unreliable. That is normal practice, not a failure.

01

SECTION ONE

The Service-Business Model, and Why It Beats Gig Work

A one-off job pays you once and then you start again from zero. A package pays you a little more and still ends. A monthly retainer pays you whether or not you find a new client this week, which is the only structure that lets you plan. This section shows the arithmetic, explains why a small local business buys a service at all, names the four things that kill beginner service businesses, and gives you a scoring sheet for choosing your first service.

01 Three ways to be paid: job, package, retainer

02 The arithmetic of recurring revenue

03 Why a small local business buys a service

04 The four things that kill a beginner service business

05 Choosing your first service: the opportunity score

06 Worksheet: your first service decision

Gig work is being paid for a task. A service business is being paid for an outcome on a schedule. The difference is not ambition, it is arithmetic, and the arithmetic decides whether you can plan your month or not.

12
ONE-OFF JOBS TO MATCH FOUR RETAINERS

4
CONVERSATIONS INSTEAD OF TWELVE

1
SERVICE TO SELL UNTIL IT WORKS

1.1 Three ways to be paid

Almost everything you can sell falls into one of three shapes. Learn to recognise them, because beginners accidentally choose the worst one.

SHAPE	WHAT YOU SELL	WHEN IT ENDS	WHAT IT DOES TO YOUR MONTH
One-off job	A single piece of work: one poster, one edited video, one fixed listing	The moment you deliver	You start next month from zero and must find a new buyer
Package	A bundle of work with a fixed price and a fixed scope: eight posts, thirty products, one setup plus four weeks	At the end of the bundle	Bigger single payment, but the same restart problem
Monthly retainer	An agreed monthly outcome, paid monthly, renewed by default	Only when the client stops trading or stops seeing value	Your income from last month mostly repeats, so effort goes into growth

Every price mentioned in this book is an example for teaching. No verified local rate card for these services exists.

A package is a bridge, not a destination. Most of the ten services in this book can be sold first as a package, because a suspicious owner will pay once before committing monthly. Your job is to convert that package into a retainer at delivery, which is a conversation Section 09 gives you word for word.

1.2 The arithmetic of recurring revenue

Here is the comparison that matters. Both columns describe a target example for teaching. Neither is a forecast. The numbers are chosen so the arithmetic is plain to follow, not because they are what you will earn.

OVER TWELVE MONTHS	TWELVE ONE-OFF JOBS	FOUR MONTHLY CLIENTS
Price per sale (example)	$9 per job	$16 per client per month
Sales conversations needed	12 closes, from roughly 60 to 120 approaches	4 closes, from roughly 20 to 40 approaches
Deliveries you must manage	12 separate scopes and deadlines	4 repeating scopes
Income in month one	$9	$16
Income in month twelve, if nothing new is sold	$0	$500
Total for the year	$18,000	$30,000

Target examples for teaching, not predictions and not guarantees. Real results depend on your service, your city, your offer and how many businesses answer you.

TARGET EXAMPLE — NOT A PREDICTION

```
4 clients × $16 = $500 per month
$500 × 12 months = $120,000 of renewal value
```

This is arithmetic, not a forecast. It shows why four recurring clients are worth more than twelve one-off jobs, and why the retainer conversation is worth having even when it feels awkward.

Notice what the table really says. The one-off column is not worse because the price is lower. It is worse because **you pay for it with sales work every single month**, and sales work is the part beginners hate and avoid. The retainer column lets the sales work from month one keep paying in month twelve.

EXPLAIN A retainer is money that repeats because the client keeps receiving a result, not because you keep asking.

SHOW A hair salon pays $12 a month for eight posts, four Stories a week and replies to messages. The owner does not renegotiate monthly, because the alternative is doing it herself at eleven at night.

DO Write down the monthly outcome you could repeat for a client without inventing new work every month. If you cannot describe it in one sentence, it is not a retainer yet.

CHECK Your sentence names a quantity and a rhythm: "eight posts and message replies, every month". If it says "manage social media", it is not a scope.

1.3 Why a small local business buys a service

Owners do not buy "digital". They buy one of four outcomes, and they will only pay for the one they already feel.

WHAT THEY WANT	HOW THEY SAY IT	WHAT YOU ACTUALLY DELIVER
More customers	"Business is slow."	Consistent posts, a working Maps listing, a catalogue people can send to friends
Saved time	"I do not have time for this."	You take over the posting, the replies, the photographing, the updating
Looking professional	"Customers ask if we are still open."	Clean design, correct hours, recent photographs, a real reply when someone writes
Being findable	"People cannot find us."	Correct Google Maps listing, correct spelling of the name, correct phone number, real location pin

THE RULE THAT FOLLOWS

Sell the outcome the owner already mentioned, in the owner's own words. If the owner says business is slow, do not open with a discussion about content pillars. Open with the three things you noticed on their page that a customer would also notice.

1.4 The four things that kill a beginner service business

01 No niche

You offer everything to everybody, so no owner remembers you. **Fix:** one service, one client type, one city, for thirty days. "I keep Google Maps listings correct for guest houses in a regional city" beats "I do digital marketing".

02 No proof

You have nothing to show, so the owner has to take a risk on a stranger. **Fix:** build three clearly labelled samples before your first approach. Label every one "Sample — created by [your name] for demonstration".

03 No follow-up

You send one message, get no reply, and stop. **Fix:** three touches over twenty-one days, each one adding something new. Most replies come after the first message is forgotten.

04 No price

You say "it depends" or "whatever you think is fair", and the owner hears "this person is not a business". **Fix:** publish a starting price for a defined package and say it out loud, even when your hands are sweating.

THE FIFTH KILLER, WHICH ONLY APPEARS LATER

Taking work you cannot deliver. If a client asks for something outside your service, the honest answer is "that is not what I do, but here is who can". One over-promise costs you the referral that would have brought two more clients.

1.5 Choosing your first service: the opportunity score

Do not choose the service you find most interesting. Choose the one that scores highest on six things you can actually check. Score each service from 1 to 5 on every row, then add up. Maximum 30.

CRITERION	SCORE 1	SCORE 5
Skill you already have	You would start from nothing	You could deliver a decent version today
Proof you can build alone	You need a real client's data to show anything	You can make a labelled sample this week
Chance it repeats monthly	It is finished when delivered	It has an obvious monthly version
Access to the buyers	You do not know where they are	You can list twenty of them on Maps tonight
Price against your time	Ten hours for a small payment	Two hours for a fair payment
Deliverable on your phone	Needs a laptop every time	Phone only, end to end

Service I scored highest .....

Its total score out of 30 .....

The one client type I will serve .....

The city or area I will work in .....

What I will refuse to sell for thirty days .....

TARGET, NOT GUARANTEE

If your winning service scores below 20, that is information. It usually means the skill is not there yet or the buyers are hard to reach. Spend two weeks learning the skill before you spend four weeks selling it.

1.6 Worksheet: your first service decision

Fill this in before you read Section 04. You will change your mind later, and that is fine, but you need a written starting position or you will read ten service chapters and choose none of them.

My service, in six words .....

My client type, in four words .....

My starting package and its example price .....

How many hours a week I can protect for this .....

The date I will send my first ten messages .....

Keep this page. In thirty days you will read it again and see exactly where your thinking changed, which is worth more than any plan that was never written down.

02

SECTION TWO

How local Businesses Actually Buy

The person who decides is almost always the owner, and the owner decides in a way that has nothing to do with a marketing funnel. This section covers who really signs off, whether to walk in, send a direct message or phone, how trust and referral work, how price comes up, what a deposit means, the polite ways to ask for money, how to survive "come back next week", and the behaviour that turns one client into three.

01 The decision-maker is the owner

02 Walk-in, DM or phone: the best channel by business type

03 Trust, referral and the role of a known name

04 How price is actually discussed

05 Deposits: what they mean and how to ask

06 Handling "come back next week"

07 Behaviour that generates referrals

You are not selling to a company. You are selling to one busy person who is standing behind a counter, holding a phone, and deciding in about forty seconds whether you are worth ten more minutes.

Everything in this section is about that forty seconds.

2.1 The decision-maker is the owner

In a small local business, there is rarely a marketing manager, a procurement process or a committee. There is the owner, and often the owner's spouse or a long-serving employee who has real influence. Your whole approach is designed to reach that person.

BUSINESS TYPE	WHO DECIDES	BEST FIRST CHANNEL
Café, restaurant, juice house, bakery	Owner, usually on site from opening	Walk in during the quiet hour, between 14:00 and 16:00
Boutique, shoe shop, cosmetics shop	Owner, often a woman who runs the counter herself	Walk in, or a direct message to the shop page with a specific observation
Guest house, small hotel, lodge	Owner or manager, rarely on site during the day	Phone first, then a scheduled visit
Tour operator, car rental, travel agent	Owner, reachable by phone and email	Direct message or phone, then email a one-page offer
Clinic, dental clinic, pharmacy	Owner-doctor or owner-pharmacist	Walk in with a printed one-pager, outside peak hours
Gym, fitness centre, sports club	Owner, often young and online	Instagram or Telegram direct message
Furniture maker, metalwork, tailoring	Owner, on the workshop floor	Walk in, in the afternoon when the workshop is slower
Kindergarten, tutorial centre, private school	Director or owner	Phone for an appointment, then a formal visit with a printed offer
Real estate agent, event decorator, wedding planner	Owner, extremely phone-driven	Phone call, then WhatsApp with samples

Channel advice is practical guidance, not a verified statistic. Adjust it to what you observe in your own city.

2.2 Walk-in, DM or phone

Walk-in

Best for: shops, cafés, workshops, clinics. **Strength:** the owner sees a real person and can look at your phone screen. **Weakness:** you must catch a quiet moment, and you will sometimes be turned away in front of customers. **Rule:** never go at a peak hour, always bring your phone charged with samples already open, and leave within five minutes if the owner is busy.

Direct message

Best for: businesses that already post actively. **Strength:** free, fast, and you can attach a sample. **Weakness:** often ignored and often mistaken for spam. **Rule:** name one specific thing you noticed, never send a paragraph, and never send the same text to twenty businesses on the same day.

Phone call

Best for: guest houses, tour operators, clinics, schools, anyone with a landline or a number printed on the door. **Strength:** fastest way to find out whether the owner is interested. **Weakness:** you must be ready to talk without notes. **Rule:** thirty seconds maximum, one clear reason for calling, and a request for a specific time to send details.

Referral or introduction

Best for: everything. **Strength:** the owner already trusts you because someone they know vouched. **Weakness:** you cannot manufacture it, only earn it. **Rule:** always ask a satisfied client whether you may mention their name, and never use a name without permission.

2.3 Trust and referral

An owner is not evaluating your skill first. They are evaluating risk: will this person disappear with my money, embarrass my business, or waste my time. That is why three things matter more than your portfolio.

— **Do what you said, when you said it.** Sending a draft on Thursday when you promised Thursday is worth more than a beautiful draft on Sunday.

— **Be findable and consistent.** One phone number, one name, one page, the same photo everywhere. A person with a real presence is a lower risk than a stranger with a blank profile.

— **Be honest about what you cannot do.** Saying "I do not do printing, but I will give the printer the correct files" builds more trust than pretending to do everything.

Referrals where you live move through people, not through advertising. One café owner who is happy will mention you to the boutique next door, the supplier who delivers their milk, and their cousin who runs a guest house. That is why a client who pays a small amount and stays for six months is worth more to you than a big one-off job.

> **ASK FOR THE REFERRAL AT THE RIGHT MOMENT**
>
> Ask in the week a client compliments your work, not at the end of the contract. The sentence is short: "If you know one other owner who has the same problem, I would be grateful for an introduction." Nothing more. Do not ask them to sell for you.

2.4 How price is actually discussed

The owner will often ask "how much?" within the first two minutes, before you have explained anything. This is normal and it is not rudeness. It is how a busy person filters. Do not dodge the question, and do not answer it with a number you invented on the spot.

1. **Give a real range immediately**
   "For what I described, clients start at around $25 a month, and it depends on how many posts and whether I take the photographs." A range with a reason is a professional answer. "It depends" is not.

1. **Ask what they spend now**
   "What do you currently pay for the closest thing to this?" You will often hear a number, and sometimes you will hear that a relative does it for free, which tells you the real competition is not another agency.

1. **Write the number down in front of them**
   Say the price and the scope in one sentence, then send it in a message the same day. A price that exists only in conversation gets remembered as something smaller.

2. **Do not discount without removing something**
   If they cannot pay $25, offer $16 for four posts instead of eight. Never lower the price for the same work. The first discount teaches the client that your prices are fiction.

2.5 Deposits: what they mean and how to ask

A deposit is not a sign of distrust. In local small business, an advance payment is how almost everything is bought: the printer takes a deposit, the supplier takes a deposit, the carpenter takes a deposit. Asking for one puts you in the same category as every other supplier the owner deals with.

JOB SIZE (EXAMPLE)	DEPOSIT TO ASK FOR	WHY
Under $12	Full payment before delivery, or 50 per cent	The amount is small enough that chasing it costs more than the work
2,000 to $8,000	50 per cent up front, 50 per cent on delivery	Covers your time if the client vanishes mid-project
Monthly retainer	First month in advance, then on the first working day of each month	Removes the monthly chasing conversation completely
Anything requiring you to buy materials or pay someone else	Cost of materials plus 50 per cent of your fee	You must never fund a client's job from your own pocket

Deposit terms are a commercial convention described here for teaching, not a legal requirement.

2.6 Handling "come back next week"

"Come back next week" is the most common answer you will get, and it can mean four different things. Guess wrong and you either waste three weeks or lose the client by pushing.

WHAT THEY MEAN	HOW YOU CAN TELL	WHAT YOU DO
Genuinely busy this week	They gave you a specific day or asked you to call	Agree the exact day, send a one-line reminder the morning of, and turn up
Interested but not convinced	They asked questions but not about price	Leave one piece of proof, then follow up in three days with a sample made for their business

WHAT THEY MEAN	HOW YOU CAN TELL	WHAT YOU DO
Cannot pay right now	Money came up in the conversation	Offer the smallest package, or a start date at the beginning of next month

WHAT THEY MEAN	HOW YOU CAN TELL	WHAT YOU DO
Polite no	No questions, no eye contact, no specific day	Thank them, leave your contact, and move on. Do not spend three more weeks there

The follow-up rhythm that works without pestering: message two days later with something useful; message again after seven days with a sample or observation; message a final time after twenty-one days and then stop. Three touches, twenty-one days, each one adding something new. A follow-up that adds nothing is a nag.

COPY-READY: THE DAY-TWO FOLLOW-UP

Selam [owner's name], this is [your name] from [day you met]. No pressure — I was looking at your page again and noticed [one specific thing, e.g. the opening hours are missing]. I fixed it on a sample so you can see what I mean: [Drive link].

If it is useful, I can do the same for the whole page. If not, no problem at all — I will not keep messaging you.

2.7 Behaviour that generates referrals

— **Address people respectfully.** Use the polite plural forms with anyone older or in a formal role, and the informal form only once they use it with you.

— **Never over-promise.** "I will try to have it by Thursday" is weaker than "I will send a draft Thursday morning". Say the thing you can hold to.

— **Follow up without pressure.** One useful message, then wait. Two messages is follow-up. Five is a reason to block you.

— **Do not discuss one client with another.** If a competitor asks what you charge someone else, the answer is "prices depend on scope".

— **Credit other people.** If a photographer, a printer or another freelancer helped you, name them when it is relevant. The favour returns.

— **Finish small jobs properly.** The $5 poster you delivered on time is what gets you recommended for the $75 project.

EXPLAIN Referral is the cheapest client acquisition there is, but it cannot be bought. It is earned by being low-risk and straightforward to deal with.

SHOW You fix a Maps listing for a guest house in a regional city for $16. The owner mentions it to the tour operator she buys transport from. That operator asks you to do the same for three vehicles' worth of listings.

DO After your next delivered job, ask one question: "If you know one other owner with the same problem, would you be willing to introduce me?"

CHECK You asked without writing a paragraph, you accepted a no without arguing, and you did not use the client's name anywhere without permission.

03

SECTION THREE

The Ten Services, at a Glance

Ten services an individual with a phone, a free tool stack and no licence can sell to local small local businesses. For each one you get what it is, who buys it, the beginner skill it needs, the free tools that deliver it, an example price in dollars, a realistic delivery time and whether it can repeat monthly. Sections 04 to 08 take each one apart in full.

01 How to read these tables

02 The ten services: what they are and who buys them

03 Tools, example prices, delivery time and recurrence

04 Which services need a laptop

05 Choosing your first three candidates

Read this section once, quickly. Then pick two or three candidates and read only their chapters. Reading all ten in full and choosing none is the most common way to finish this book with nothing.

ABOUT EVERY PRICE ON THIS PAGE

These are **example prices for teaching**. No published local rate card for these services could be verified, so no honest book can tell you what your city pays. Use these numbers as a starting position you will correct after three clients.

3.1 How to read these tables

Two columns do most of the work. **Beginner skill** tells you how long you must practise before someone should pay you. **Recurring?** tells you whether the service can become a monthly retainer, which is the whole point of Section 01.

— **One-off only** means the money stops when the work stops. Still worth doing as a bridge, never as a plan.

— **Both** means you can sell a fixed project first and convert it into a monthly relationship, which is the ideal shape.

— **Monthly by nature** means the client is buying an ongoing result and will expect you to keep going.

3.2 The ten services: what they are and who buys them

#	SERVICE	WHAT IT IS	WHO BUYS IT	BEGINNER SKILL NEEDED
1	**Social-media management**	Running a business page: posts, Stories, replies, a simple monthly plan	Cafés, boutiques, salons, gyms, guest houses, event businesses	Comfortable using the platform daily; basic phone photography
2	**Canva design**	Posts, price lists, menus, flyers, simple logos, business cards	Almost every small business, plus event organisers and NGOs	Layout, spacing, readable fonts, correct the local language typing
3	**Short-form video editing**	Cutting, captioning and sizing vertical video for Reels, TikTok and Shorts	Restaurants, gyms, clothing shops, tour operators, musicians	Basic editing in a phone app; understanding of hooks and pacing
4	**Google Business Profile assistance**	Claiming, correcting and maintaining the Maps listing so customers can find and trust it	Clinics, guest houses, repair shops, showrooms, anyone with a physical address	Careful reading and form filling; no coding
5	**Basic website setup**	A one-page or small multi-page site with contact details, services, photos and a map	Tour operators, consultancies, schools, clinics, exporters	Patience with a builder tool; basic writing

#	SERVICE	WHAT IT IS	WHO BUYS IT	BEGINNER SKILL NEEDED
6	**Product and catalog digitisation**	Photographing products and building a clean, priced catalogue the client can send to customers	Furniture, fashion, electronics, spare parts, ceramics, wholesalers	Phone photography in daylight; tidy spreadsheet work

#	SERVICE	WHAT IT IS	WHO BUYS IT	BEGINNER SKILL NEEDED
7	**WhatsApp and Telegram support setup**	Setting up a business number, catalogue, quick replies and an order flow that actually gets answered	Restaurants, shops, clinics, real estate, anyone taking orders by DM	Understanding of the apps; clear writing
8	**Content writing**	Captions, product descriptions, service pages, simple blog posts in English or the local language	Hotels, tour companies, clinics, schools, consultancies, exporters	Clean grammar in one language; ability to interview an owner
9	**AI-assisted business documentation**	Company profiles, price lists, proposals, quotation templates, staff checklists, drafted with AI and corrected by you	Contractors, suppliers, consultancies, NGOs, tender-bidding businesses	Ability to edit AI output properly and verify every fact
10	**Lead-generation assistance**	Building a researched list of potential customers for a business, with contact details and a first message	Event venues, training centres, B2B suppliers, real estate, gyms	Systematic research on Maps and directories; disciplined record keeping

All business types listed are categories, not named companies. Every client example anywhere in this book is fictional.

3.3 Tools, example prices, delivery time and recurrence

#	FREE TOOLS THAT DELIVER IT	EXAMPLE PRICE (DOLLARS)	TYPICAL DELIVERY	RECURRING?
1	Facebook, Instagram, Telegram, Google Sheets, a free design tool	4,000 to 8,000 per month	Set up in 3 days, then monthly	Monthly by nature
2	A free design tool with templates, phone camera	400 to 900 per piece; 3,500 per bundle of 12	24 to 72 hours per piece	Both
3	CapCut, InShot or VN Editor	600 to 1,200 per video; 6,000 per bundle of 8	1 to 2 days per video	Both
4	Google Maps, Google Business Profile, phone camera	2,500 setup; 1,500 to 2,500 per month	Setup in 2 days, upkeep monthly	Monthly by nature
5	A free website builder with a free subdomain, Google Drive for content	8,000 starter; 15,000 standard; 2,000 per month care	5 to 14 days	Both
6	Phone camera, Google Sheets, a free document tool	3,000 for 30 products; 7,000 for 100	3 to 7 days	Both
7	WhatsApp Business, Telegram, Google Docs	3,500 setup; 6,000 setup plus training; 2,500 per month	2 to 4 days	Monthly by nature

#	FREE TOOLS THAT DELIVER IT	EXAMPLE PRICE (DOLLARS)	TYPICAL DELIVERY	RECURRING?
8	Google Docs, a notes app, a free AI chat tool where available	500 to 1,000 per piece; 5,000 per bundle of 8	2 to 4 days per piece	Both
9	Google Docs, Google Sheets, a free AI chat tool where available	3,000 starter; 6,500 standard; 2,000 per month	3 to 10 days	Both
10	Google Maps, a local classifieds site, an online business directory, an online business directory, Google Sheets	2,500 per campaign; 6,000 to 8,000 per month	3 to 5 days per list	Monthly by nature

Every figure is an example for teaching, not a market rate and not a guarantee. Free plans change: verify the current free limits of any tool before you build a paid workflow on it.

3.4 Which services need a laptop

SERVICE	PHONE ONLY	LAPTOP GENUINELY HELPS
Social-media management	Yes, end to end	Only for writing long monthly plans comfortably
Canva design	Yes for posts and single pages	Multi-page menus, print-ready files with exact sizes
Short-form video	Yes, and it is the normal way to do it	Only for long footage or batch editing of many clips
Google Business Profile	Yes	No real advantage
Website setup	A one-page site is possible	Yes, for anything larger. Plan one café hour per site.
Catalog digitisation	Photography yes, editing yes	Yes for large spreadsheets and bulk uploads
WhatsApp and Telegram setup	Yes	No real advantage
Content writing	Yes, for short pieces	Yes for long documents and careful editing
AI-assisted documentation	Drafting yes	Yes, strongly. Long documents are painful on a phone.
Lead generation	Yes, slowly	Yes, for lists over about fifty rows

3.5 Choosing your first three candidates

Go back to the opportunity score in Section 01 and score four services: the one you can already do best, the one that recurs most naturally, the one whose buyers you can reach tonight, and one other that interests you. Then pick the winner and read only its chapter.

Candidate 1 and score .....

Candidate 2 and score .....

Candidate 3 and score .....

My decision, in one sentence .....

EXPLAIN Ten services exist so that one of them fits your situation. They are not ten businesses to run at once.

SHOW A reader in a regional city with good English but no design skill scores content writing 26 and Canva design 14. She sells writing to guest houses and tour operators, and delivers the design work later as a second service.

DO Write your decision in one sentence and put it where you will see it daily, such as your phone lock screen.

CHECK You can say your service, your client type and your example starting price in one breath, without reading from the book.

04

SECTION FOUR

Services One to Three: Pages, Design and Video

The three most visible services, and the three most crowded. Each one is taken apart in full: who buys it, the problem as the client describes it, the beginner skill and how long it takes to learn, the free tools, a complete sample offer, an example price ladder, where to find clients, a copy-ready outreach script, the delivery workflow, the upsell and the recurring-revenue path.

01 Service 1: Social-media management

02 Service 2: Canva design

03 Service 3: Short-form video editing

04 How the three fit together as one offer

These three are the most familiar to explain to a client and the hardest to stand out in. The way you stand out is not better design. It is a narrower client type, a defined monthly scope and reliable delivery.

One fully worked fictional client example is included for each service. Every business named in this book is invented.

4.1 Service one: social-media management

Running a business page on a schedule: posts, Stories, replies to messages and comments, plus a simple monthly plan.

Who buys it

Cafés, restaurants, juice houses, boutiques, beauty salons, barber shops, gyms, guest houses, event decorators and anyone whose customers already look at a phone before they walk in. The buyer is almost always the owner, and the owner is usually the person who has been posting badly at midnight for two years.

The problem it solves, in the client's own terms

Owners say versions of three sentences: "I do not have time for this." "Customers ask if we are still open." "People message and I forget to answer." They are not asking to go viral. They are asking for the page to stop looking abandoned, because an abandoned page makes a real business look closed.

Beginner skill you need, and how long to learn it

You must be comfortable using the platform daily, able to take a clear photograph in daylight, and able to write two or three short lines in the language your client's customers speak. Give yourself **two to three weeks of daily practice** before you charge: post every day on a page of your own, study five local business pages that do it well, and learn how to schedule and how to reply quickly. Nothing here needs a laptop.

Free tools

— The platform's own business tools: Facebook Page, Instagram, Telegram channel

— A free design tool with templates for post layouts

— Google Sheets for the monthly content plan and the reply log

— Your phone camera in daylight, with a plain wall or a window as your studio

Sample offer, written as a package

> **THE OFFER YOU CAN READ OUT LOUD**
>
> **Eight posts a month, four Stories a week, every message answered within one working hour, and a one-page plan for the month sent to you before the first post goes up.** I take the photographs on one visit a month. You approve the plan in one message. If you want to change something, you change it before the plan is approved, not after the post is written.

Sample pricing in USD

LEVEL	WHAT IS INCLUDED	EXAMPLE PRICE
Starter	4 posts a month, replies to messages, monthly one-page plan	$25/month
Standard	8 posts, 4 Stories a week, replies, one photo visit a month, monthly plan	$7,500/month

LEVEL	WHAT IS INCLUDED	EXAMPLE PRICE
Monthly plus	Standard plus one short video a week and a simple boosted-post recommendation	$500/month

LEVEL	WHAT IS INCLUDED	EXAMPLE PRICE
First-month trial package	4 posts, replies, plan, no photograph visit, one month only	$16 one-off

Example prices only, for teaching. Confirm what local businesses already pay before you fix your own number.

How to find clients for this service

— **Search terms:** on Google Maps, search the client type plus the area, in the local spelling: "cafe the commercial district", "beauty salon a regional city", "gym a regional city", "guest house a regional city".

— **Neighbourhoods in your city:** the commercial district, Kazanchis, Megenagna, Gerji, CMC, Summit, Sarbet, Ayat, Lafto, Piassa, the central district. In other cities, the commercial street nearest the main roundabout or the university gate.

— **Business types:** cafés, juice houses, burger and pizza places, boutiques, cosmetics shops, barber shops, salons, gyms, phone accessory shops, event decorators.

— **Directory and classifieds:** the online business directory at `https://businessguide.ezega.com/` lists restaurants and cafés among its categories, and a local classifieds site at `https://jiji.com.et/` shows live, dollars-priced listings by district.

— **The filter that saves you weeks:** only approach businesses whose page exists but has not been posted on in more than 30 days, or whose last ten posts are all reposted flyers with no photographs. A business posting well does not need you yet.

Outreach script

COPY-READY: FIRST MESSAGE, SOCIAL-MEDIA MANAGEMENT

Selam **[owner's name]**. I am **[your name]**, I am in **[area]** and I run business pages for **[client type, e.g. small cafes]**.

I looked at **[business name]** because **[honest reason]**. Two things stood out: **[problem one, e.g. the last post was in March]** and **[problem two, e.g. the menu photo has no prices]**.

I made one sample post for you so this is not just talk: **[Drive link]**. It is a sample, made to show you what I mean.

If you want, I can keep eight posts a month going and answer your messages, starting at **[example price]** USD a month. If it is not useful, tell me and I will not message again.

Delivery workflow, step by step

1. **Get access and a content source**

   Ask the owner to add you as an admin, never to hand over the password. Ask what they sell most, what they want more of, and what they never want posted.

2. **Photograph once a month**

   One visit, thirty to forty minutes, daylight, twelve to twenty usable photographs and two short clips. Agree the visit day in advance and put it in your phone calendar.

1. **Write the month plan in one page**
   Eight lines: date, post idea, one line of caption direction. Send it for approval. Keep approval in writing, even if it is a thumbs-up in a chat.
1. **Prepare everything in one sitting**
   Design all eight posts and write all eight captions in a single two-hour block. This is how you protect your hourly rate.
1. **Schedule or post on the agreed days**
   Post at the times the client's customers are actually on their phones, which for food businesses is usually before meal times.
2. **Reply within one working hour**
   Answer questions, pass real orders to the owner by forwarding the message, and never quote a price the owner has not given you.
3. **Send a five-line monthly report**
   Posts published, messages answered, best-performing post, one thing you recommend for next month, and your invoice.

The upsell

Short-form video, sold as an add-on: one edited vertical video a week for an extra monthly amount. Video is the natural next step because you are already on site with a camera and you already know the menu. After that, the second upsell is a Google Business Profile clean-up, which is a separate service in this book and takes two days.

The recurring-revenue path

This service is monthly by nature, which is why it is first in the book. The conversion that matters is from the trial package to the Standard retainer. Ask for that decision in the monthly report, at the moment the owner is looking at evidence of what you did, not at the end of the month in a separate message.

EXAMPLE SCENARIO — FICTIONAL

Client: Riverside Coffee House, a 20-seat café near Kazanchis, your city. Fictional.

Situation: The owner's nephew posts a flyer once or twice a month. The Facebook page has 1,100 followers, the last post was in March, and the menu photograph is from 2023 with no prices. Messages go unanswered for days.

What you sell: a one-month trial at $16 — four posts, replies, monthly plan. You photograph on one visit and produce four posts in one sitting.

What happens next: after four weeks the owner has seen the monthly report and the reply log. You offer Standard at $7,500 a month. If the owner says the price is high, you offer Starter at $25 with four posts and replies instead of eight posts and a photo visit. You do not lower the price for the same scope.

Nothing here is promised. This is what a well-run version of the conversation looks like, not a forecast of your results.

EXPLAIN You are not selling creativity. You are selling consistency, response time and a page that looks alive.

SHOW A juice house with eleven followers and one post from 2024 gets four real photographs, correct hours and a reply to every message for one month. The owner can now send the page link to a customer who asks whether they deliver.

DO Choose your client type and build three labelled sample posts for three invented businesses of that type. Save them in one Drive folder with view access on.

CHECK Every sample says "Sample — created by [your name] for demonstration". You can describe your monthly scope in one sentence with a number in it.

4.2 Service two: Canva design

Producing the visual pieces a small business needs: posts, price lists, menus, flyers, simple business cards, simple logos.

Who buys it

Almost everyone, which is exactly why you must narrow it. The best buyers are businesses that print or display things regularly: cafés and restaurants with changing menus, boutiques with seasonal sales, event decorators, wedding planners, tutoring centres with term flyers, and small NGOs needing reports and posters. Event businesses are the best single niche because their deadlines are fixed and their budgets are decided in advance.

The problem it solves, in the client's own terms

"My nephew made it in his phone." "The printer said the file is wrong." "The the local language is spelled incorrectly." "I need it for tomorrow." The real problem is not beauty. It is that a badly produced flyer costs the owner money: wrong price, wrong phone number, unreadable text in a small size, or a file the print shop cannot use.

Beginner skill you need, and how long to learn it

Learn five things: contrast, alignment, repetition, spacing and hierarchy. Then learn to type the local language correctly, which is a skill in itself and one that most competitors do not have. Give yourself **two weeks of daily practice**, one finished piece a day, and read every piece out loud before you export. A phone is enough for posts and single-page work; multi-page menus and print-ready files are much better on a laptop.

Free tools

— A free design tool with templates, used at its free tier

— Google Drive for version control: one folder per client, one file per version

— Your phone camera for mock-ups, so the client can see the poster on a wall

— A free image-compression tool before sending anything

Sample offer, written as a package

> **THE OFFER YOU CAN READ OUT LOUD**
>
> **Twelve designed pieces a month, in the sizes you need, with two rounds of corrections on each, delivered as files your printer can use and as phone-sized images you can post.** You send me the text and the photographs; I send the first version within 24 hours and the final within 72. I will tell you when a text is too long to read at that size, instead of shrinking it until nobody can see it.

Sample pricing in USD

LEVEL	WHAT IS INCLUDED	EXAMPLE PRICE
Starter	5 pieces a month, one correction round each	$9/month
Standard	12 pieces a month, two correction rounds, print and screen versions	$22/month
Monthly plus	Standard plus one menu or price list update a week and priority on urgent jobs	$35/month
Single piece	One poster or post, one correction round	400 to $6

Example prices only. No verified local rate card for design work could be found when this course was written.

How to find clients for this service

— **Search terms:** look for businesses that advertise offline constantly: "menu" plus restaurant names on Maps, "wedding planner Addis", "event decorator a regional city", "tutorial centre a regional city".

— **Neighbourhoods:** around printing shops anywhere in the country. Stand near a print shop for twenty minutes and watch who walks in with a bad file. That is your market, and the print shop owner is a potential referrer.

— **Business types:** restaurants, cafés, boutiques, cosmetics shops, wedding and event businesses, tutorial centres, private clinics, churches and community organisations, small NGOs.

— **Physical surfaces:** photograph the posters stuck on shop windows. Note the ones with spelling mistakes, unreadable text or an old date. Those are leads, and you can describe the exact problem in your first message.

— **Directories:** a local classifieds site at `https://jiji.com.et/` shows shops by district, and the online business directory at `https://www.an online business directory.com/directory` lists more than ten thousand companies with a free "Add your Business" option.

Outreach script

COPY-READY: FIRST MESSAGE, DESIGN WORK

Selam [owner's name], I am [your name], a designer working with [client type] in [city].

I saw your poster for [event or offer]. I redesigned it so you can compare — it is attached, and it is clearly labelled as a sample I made to show you: [file].

The main change is that the price and the phone number are now readable from two metres away, which is how far most people are when they read a window poster.

If you like it, I do twelve pieces a month from [example price] USD, including print files. If you only need this one poster, that is [example price] USD. Either way, the sample file is yours to use.

Delivery workflow, step by step

1 **Collect the raw material in one message**

Ask for four things: exact text, logo file if one exists, any photograph they want used, and the size or the place it will be displayed. Never start without the exact text.

1 **Confirm the text in writing before designing**

Read the local language out loud, check every phone number digit by digit, and send the text back for confirmation. This single step prevents most revisions.

1. **Design in one sitting**
   Choose one layout, one font family, one accent colour. Beginners lose hours by trying six versions. Make one good version and one alternative, never six.
1. **Export both versions**
   A print file for the printer and a compressed phone image for the client's page. Name the files clearly: client-name, piece, version, date.
1. **Deliver with a mock-up**
   Send the design plus one photograph of it on a screen or a wall. Clients approve faster when they can picture it in place.
2. **Handle corrections in one round**
   Collect every correction in one message, make all changes at once, and send a numbered list of what changed.
3. **Archive the final file**
   One folder per client in your Drive, with the final file and the exact text saved as a document. Next month's job will take half the time.

The upsell

Print liaison: you prepare the print-ready file, speak to the printer, and check the first printed copy. This is paid work and it is the thing clients fear most, because they have all had a print job come back wrong. Your second upsell is social-media management, since you are already producing the images.

The recurring-revenue path

Design becomes recurring when you tie it to a business rhythm rather than a request: twelve pieces a month covers a café's weekly specials, a boutique's new arrivals and a tutoring centre's term announcements. Write the rhythm into the offer. If you sell single pieces only, you will be chasing a new order every two weeks.

EXAMPLE SCENARIO — FICTIONAL

Client: Lakeview Style House, a women's clothing boutique near the lake road, a regional city. Fictional.

Situation: The owner posts photographs of new arrivals with no prices and no sizes, using a different layout every time. Customers message to ask prices, and she answers the same question fifteen times a day.

What you sell: a Standard package at $22 a month — twelve pieces, two correction rounds, print and screen versions. The first month produces a one-page price list she can send as a single image, plus a fixed post layout with price, size and fabric in the same place every time.

What happens next: she stops answering the same question repeatedly, which is the actual value. The following month you quote social-media management as an additional service, and she decides. She may say no, and that is a normal outcome.

Example only. No result is promised.

EXPLAIN Good design for a small local business means readable at a distance, correct in the local language, and usable by a printer. Beauty is fourth on that list.

SHOW A tutoring centre flyer with six different fonts, a phone number in 8-point type and a fee that is out of date. The redesign has one font family, the phone number in the largest text on the page, and the current fee.

DO Photograph five posters on shop windows in your area today. Redesign the worst one as a labelled sample, and use it in your first outreach message to that business.

CHECK Someone standing two metres away can read the business name, the offer and the phone number without effort, and the local language has been checked by a second person.

4.3 Service three: short-form video editing

Cutting vertical video for Reels, TikTok and Shorts: trimming, captions, music, text overlays and correct sizing, delivered ready to post.

Who buys it

Restaurants with a signature dish, gyms, clothing shops, tour operators with scenery, musicians, cosmetics sellers, event businesses, and anyone whose product looks better in motion than in a photograph. The strongest buyers are businesses that already film material themselves but never post it, because editing is the step they abandon.

The problem it solves, in the client's own terms

"I have forty videos in my phone and I never post them." "It takes me three hours to make one." "The video is too long and people scroll past." The owner is not short of footage. They are short of the hour it takes to turn footage into something postable, and they do not enjoy doing it.

Beginner skill you need, and how long to learn it

Learn four things: cutting on the beat, adding readable captions, keeping the first two seconds interesting, and exporting at the right size and aspect ratio. **Two to four weeks** of making one video a day is realistic. CapCut, InShot and VN Editor all run on Android and all have usable free paths; InShot lets you watch an advert to remove its watermark. Video is phone work by default, so this is one of the most accessible services in the book for someone with no laptop.

Free tools

— CapCut, InShot or VN Editor for cutting and captions

— Your phone camera, or the client's own footage

— Google Drive for transferring large files, with a low-bandwidth alternative

— A free compressor, because uncompressed video will not upload on a weak connection

> **LOW-BANDWIDTH RULE**
>
> local mobile speeds can drop as low as 98 Kb/s in the worst hours, usually 16:00 to 24:00. Export at 720p, keep videos under 30 seconds where the client agrees, compress before sending, and hand over files late at night or early in the morning when the network is quieter. If the connection fails on a deadline, deliver the file in person on a memory card or by cable.

Sample offer, written as a package

THE OFFER YOU CAN READ OUT LOUD

Eight edited vertical videos a month, each under 45 seconds, with the local language or English captions, correct sizing for Reels, TikTok and Shorts, and two rounds of corrections. You send the raw footage through Drive or WhatsApp; I send the finished files ready to post, plus a suggested first line of caption for each one. I do not need you to be in the videos unless you want to be.

Sample pricing in USD

LEVEL	WHAT IS INCLUDED	EXAMPLE PRICE
Starter	4 videos a month, captions, no music licensing questions	$19/month
Standard	8 videos a month, captions, thumbnails, suggested caption lines	$35/month
Monthly plus	12 videos plus one filmed on site with you present	$55/month
Single video	One edited video from footage the client provides	600 to $8

Example prices only, for teaching. Adjust after you have timed your own delivery three times.

How to find clients for this service

— **Search terms:** on Maps, "restaurant [area]", "gym [area]", "tour operator [city]". On social platforms, search for local business accounts whose last twenty posts are all still images.

— **Neighbourhoods:** the food streets of any city. In your city, the commercial district, Kazanchis, Megenagna and Sarbet have dense restaurant clusters. In a regional city the lake-front strip, in a regional city the lake road, in a regional city the Franko area.

— **Business types:** restaurants with a signature dish, gyms, beauty salons doing transformations, clothing shops with new arrivals, tour operators, bakeries, coffee exporters showing their process.

— **The filter:** businesses that post photographs but never video. They have already accepted that they should post; they are missing the one step you sell.

— **Directories:** an online business directory at `https://businessguide.ezega.com/` gives category counts and a fourteen-city filter, useful for building a list outside your city.

Outreach script

COPY-READY: FIRST MESSAGE, VIDEO EDITING

Selam [owner's name], I am [your name]. I edit short videos for [client type] in [city].

Your page has good food photographs but no video, which is unusual for [cafe or restaurant] — video is what most people watch before they choose where to eat. I took one of your existing photos and built a 15-second sample from it so you can see the style: [link]. It is a sample, made for demonstration.

If you have any footage in your phone from the last month, send me two clips and I will edit one video for free so you can judge the quality. After that it is [example price] USD for four videos a month.

BEFORE YOU EVER OFFER A FREE EDIT

One free sample video to a business you have chosen is marketing. Free editing for everyone who asks is a job you are doing for nothing. Set the limit before you send the message, and hold it.

Delivery workflow, step by step

1. **Agree the format sheet**
   One page: video length, caption language, whether the logo appears, music style, and what the client never wants shown. Ten minutes of agreement prevents ten revisions.

2. **Collect footage properly**
   Ask for clips sent one at a time, or in a Drive folder. Name files by date and subject the moment you receive them.

3. **Cut for the first two seconds**
   Open with the most interesting frame, not a logo animation. Most viewers decide in two seconds.

4. **Caption everything**
   Most people watch without sound. Burn captions in, keep them inside the safe area so the app interface does not cover them, and check the local language spelling twice.

5. **Export at 720p and compress**
   Deliver a file small enough to upload on a weak connection. Give the client the larger file only if they ask for it and can receive it.

6. **Deliver in one folder per month**
   One Drive folder, one file per video, named by date. Send a single message listing what is inside.

7. **Record what worked**
   Ask the client which video got the most views, and write it down. That note is what makes month three better than month one, and it is what justifies raising your price.

The upsell

On-site filming: you visit once a month and film the material yourself, for an added monthly fee. This removes the client's biggest excuse and increases your value at the same time. The second upsell is social-media management, because video without posting is wasted footage.

The recurring-revenue path

Video is recurring when it is sold as a monthly volume rather than per piece. Eight videos a month is a rhythm the client can plan content around. Per-video pricing keeps you in the one-off trap, because every month you must ask for another order.

EXAMPLE SCENARIO — FICTIONAL

Client: City Fitness Center, a gym near Sarbet, your city. Fictional.

Situation: The trainer films members on his phone constantly, but nothing gets posted because editing takes him hours. His page has 2,400 followers and eleven videos in two years.

What you sell: Standard at $35 a month — eight edited videos with captions and suggested caption lines. You set up a shared Drive folder and a rule that he uploads raw clips every Sunday.

What happens next: the rhythm holds for two months, then he misses two Sundays in a row. You do not punish him; you send a reminder and offer the on-site filming add-on, which removes his part of the work entirely. He may accept or decline.

Example only, invented for teaching.

EXPLAIN You are selling the hour the owner does not want to spend, not artistic brilliance. Speed, captions and correct sizing win this work.

SHOW Forty clips of a restaurant kitchen sit unused for months. Eight edited 30-second videos turn them into a month of posts, each opening with the food, captioned in the local language, sized for vertical feeds.

DO Edit three sample videos from free stock or your own footage, label them clearly as samples, and put them in the same Drive folder as your other proof.

CHECK Each sample is under 45 seconds, captioned, readable without sound, vertical, and under about 20 MB so it can be sent on a weak connection.

4.4 How the three fit together as one offer

Sold separately, these three compete with everyone. Sold as one monthly outcome, they become hard to replace: **the page looks alive, the posts are designed, and there is a video every week.** That is a single sentence, a single monthly price and a single delivery rhythm.

BUNDLE	WHAT THE CLIENT GETS	EXAMPLE PRICE
Visibility bundle	8 posts a month, 4 Stories a week, message replies, 4 videos a month	$10,500/month
Plus design	The above plus 12 designed pieces including print versions	$13,500/month

Example bundle prices for teaching. Do not offer a bundle in your first month. Sell one service until it works.

THE TRAP IN BUNDLING

A bundle triples your delivery load. Do not offer one until you have delivered the single service twice for the same client and know exactly how long each piece takes you. A bundle you cannot deliver on time is worse than three separate refusals.

05

SECTION FIVE

Services Four and Five: Being Found, and the One-Page Site

Two services that fix a problem the owner can see with their own eyes: a business that cannot be found on Google Maps, and a business with no page to send anyone to. Both are less crowded than design and video, both are quicker to prove, and both convert into monthly upkeep more naturally than beginners expect.

01 Service 4: Google Business Profile assistance

02 Service 5: Basic website setup

03 How these two feed each other

These two services are sold to owners who have already lost a customer and know it. That makes the first conversation much more straightforward than selling design.

WHY THESE TWO ARE UNDERRATED

Most beginners chase design and video because the work is visible. The money in this book is often in the unglamorous jobs: correcting a wrong phone number on a Maps listing, or building one clean page that answers the four questions every customer asks.

5.1 Service four: Google Business Profile assistance

Claiming a business listing on Google Maps, correcting it, filling it properly, and keeping it updated so customers can find, trust and contact the business.

Who buys it

Any business with a physical door and a customer who might search for it: clinics, dental clinics, pharmacies, guest houses and small hotels, repair shops, spare-parts shops, showrooms, furniture workshops, driving schools, gyms, kindergartens and private clinics. The best buyer is a business that already has a listing with a problem: a wrong phone number, no opening hours, the wrong category, no photographs, or a duplicate listing that splits its reviews.

The problem it solves, in the client's own terms

"Customers call the old number." "People drive past us because Maps sends them the wrong way." "We have two listings and I do not know which one is real." The owner is not thinking about search rankings. They are thinking about a customer who could not find them yesterday, and that is a specific, provable loss.

Beginner skill you need, and how long to learn it

You need careful reading, accurate typing, patience with forms, and the discipline to verify a phone number twice. **One week is enough** if you work through your own listing first, then one friend's, then an invented one for practice. No coding at all. This is the single most accessible service in the book for a reader with no design or video skill, and it is done entirely from a phone.

VERIFY BEFORE YOU PROMISE

your country appears on Google's official list of supported countries for Business Profile, which is what makes this a real service here rather than a workaround. Google's support pages and available features change, so confirm it in your own account before you promise a client anything, and never guarantee a ranking position or a number of views.

Free tools

— Google Maps and the Google Business Profile interface itself

— Your phone camera for exterior, interior, product and team photographs

— Google Sheets for the client's listing record: what you changed on which date

— The client's own documents, so hours, phone numbers and spelling come from them and not from your memory

Sample offer, written as a package

THE OFFER YOU CAN READ OUT LOUD

I will find every listing for your business, get the real one verified under your control, correct the name, address, phone number, opening hours and category, remove or report duplicates, add twelve photographs you approve, and then keep it updated every month. You keep ownership of the listing. I work as a manager on your account, never as the owner, so you can remove me at any time and lose nothing.

Sample pricing in USD

LEVEL	WHAT IS INCLUDED	EXAMPLE PRICE
Fix-up (one-off)	Claim, correct, twelve photographs, duplicate report	$16
Standard setup	Fix-up plus four weeks of weekly posts and a photo visit	$28
Monthly upkeep	Hours and holiday updates, four posts a month, review replies, photo refresh	1,500 to $16/month

Example prices only, for teaching. No verified local rate card exists for this work.

How to find clients for this service

— **Search terms:** on Maps, search your own city for "clinic", "guest house", "pharmacy", "driving school", "kindergarten", "furniture". Open the results and look for listings with no hours, no photographs, a stale "permanently closed" label or two entries with the same name.

— **Neighbourhoods:** the streets you already know. In your city try Gerji, CMC, Summit, Ayat, Lafto and Gullele, where many real businesses are on Maps but badly maintained. In a regional city, a regional city, a regional city, a regional city and a regional city, start with the road to the main market.

— **Business types:** clinics, pharmacies, dental offices, guest houses, gyms, kindergartens, driving schools, print shops, spare-parts dealers, furniture showrooms.

— **Outside your city this is more straightforward:** a guest house in a regional city or a clinic in a smaller town often has no correctly maintained listing at all, and you can build a twenty-business list in one evening.

— **Directories to cross-check against:** the online business directory at `https://businessguide.ezega.com/` and the online business directory at `https://www.an online business directory.com/directory` both list companies with contact details, which lets you compare what the directory says against what Maps shows.

Outreach script

COPY-READY: FIRST MESSAGE, GOOGLE MAPS LISTING

Selam [owner's name], I am [your name], I work on Google Maps listings for [business type] in [city].

I searched for [business name] on Maps and found [exact problem: the phone number is the old one / there are no opening hours / there are two listings]. I have a screenshot here: [image].

A customer looking for you right now would see the same thing. Fixing it properly, with photographs and correct hours, is [example price] USD as a one-off. If you want it kept up to date after that, it is [example price] USD a month.

I can show you exactly what I would change before you decide anything.

Delivery workflow, step by step

1. **Audit before you touch anything**

   Screenshot the current listing. Search the business name plus the area, the old name and any spelling variation. Write down every listing you find and every error.

2. **Confirm the facts in writing**

   Exact business name as it should appear, phone number, address, opening hours including holidays, and the single most accurate category. Send this list to the owner and get it confirmed.

3. **Claim or request access as a manager**

   The owner must control the listing. If verification needs a code sent to their phone, sit with them while they receive it. Never become the owner of a client's listing.

4. **Correct the listing**

   Name, category, address, pin location, phone, hours, description in plain language, service list, and a link to their page. Change one field at a time and screenshot after each change, because some edits take time to appear.

5. **Add twelve photographs you took yourself**

   Exterior with the sign readable, interior, the counter, three products or dishes, the team if they agree, and a photograph of the entrance from the road so people can recognise it.

6. **Report duplicates and request removal**

   If a duplicate exists, use the report option and keep the reference. Tell the client this is a request, not a guaranteed removal, and check it again in two weeks.

7. **Hand over with a one-page record**

   What you changed, the date, the before-and-after screenshots, and the monthly price for keeping it current. That page is what converts a one-off into a retainer.

The upsell

Monthly upkeep: hours for holidays, four posts a month through the listing, replies to reviews, and a photograph refresh every quarter. After that, the natural next step is a one-page website or a WhatsApp business setup, because a customer who found the listing still needs somewhere to land.

The recurring-revenue path

A listing is never finished. Opening hours change, holidays change, phone numbers change, staff change, and reviews accumulate unanswered. Sell the one-off fix-up to earn trust, then convert to monthly upkeep at handover.

This is one of the most reliable conversions in the book, because the client has just seen the before-and-after with their own eyes.

EXAMPLE SCENARIO — FICTIONAL

Client: Highland Tour Link, a small tour operator office near the piazza in a regional city. Fictional.

Situation: The Maps listing shows a phone number that was disconnected two years ago, no opening hours, four photographs of which two are of a different business, and a duplicate listing with the old spelling of the name.

What you sell: a $16 fix-up. You confirm every fact in writing, the owner receives the verification code on his own phone, and you correct the listing and report the duplicate.

What happens next: two weeks later you send the before-and-after screenshots and offer monthly upkeep at $9. He accepts, or he does not. If he does not, you ask whether he knows another operator with the same problem.

Invented for teaching. No result is promised.

EXPLAIN A business listing is a factual record, not a marketing campaign. Your value is accuracy, completeness and upkeep.

SHOW A clinic in a regional city has no hours on Maps, so patients arrive at 18:00 and find the door closed. Adding correct hours and a holiday note is a two-hour job that changes somebody's day.

DO Open Maps and audit five businesses within a ten-minute walk of where you are sitting. Write the exact error for each one in a Google Sheet. That sheet is your first prospect list.

CHECK Every fact you would change has been confirmed in writing by the owner, and you can show a screenshot of the error before you ask for money.

5.2 Service five: basic website setup

A one-page or small multi-page website with the business name, what it does, services and prices where the client agrees, photographs, a map, and contact details that work.

Who buys it

Businesses that customers check before paying: tour operators, consultancies, private clinics and dental clinics, private schools and tutorial centres, guest houses and lodges, exporters, construction and engineering suppliers, and any business that bids for work and needs to look established. The strongest buyer is a business that has already lost a deal because it had nothing to send.

The problem it solves, in the client's own terms

"I send people my Telegram and they do not trust it." "The client asked for our website and we do not have one." "Everything about us is in my head and in a notebook." The real problem is credibility in a single link, and a place to send a foreign or institutional buyer who will not scroll through a social page.

Beginner skill you need, and how long to learn it

You need to be comfortable with a website builder's template editor, able to compress photographs, and able to write plain sentences from an interview with the owner. **Three to six weeks of practice** is realistic: build three complete sites for invented businesses before you charge anyone. A one-page site is possible on a phone; anything larger genuinely wants a laptop, so plan one internet-café hour per site.

THE DOMAIN RULE THAT PROTECTS YOU

A domain name costs money and the price changes often, so this course will not quote a figure. **The client buys the domain in their own name, with their own payment method, and keeps the login.** You set it up. Never buy a client's domain in your own name, even to be helpful, because it makes you the owner of something that is not yours and creates a fight you will lose.

Free tools

— A free website builder with a free subdomain, so the client can start at no cost and add a domain later

— Google Drive for collecting text and photographs from the client

— A free image compressor, because an uncompressed photograph makes a site unusable on a weak connection

— Google Maps for the correct location pin and directions link

Sample offer, written as a package

THE OFFER YOU CAN READ OUT LOUD

One clean page, live within ten days, containing: what you do, who you do it for, your services, three photographs, your location on a map, your phone number, and a WhatsApp button that opens a chat with you. I interview you for forty minutes, write the text, and send it to you for correction before it goes live. Two rounds of changes are included. A domain name, if you want one, is bought by you in your own name.

Sample pricing in USD

LEVEL	WHAT IS INCLUDED	EXAMPLE PRICE
Starter	One page, free subdomain, contact button, two correction rounds	$8,000 one-off
Standard	Up to five pages, contact form, gallery, basic structure for search engines	$15,000 one-off
Monthly care	Hosting checks, text and price updates, one new photograph set per quarter, uptime check	$12/month

Example prices only. Domain and hosting costs are separate, are paid by the client in their own name, and change often, so verify current prices before quoting anything.

How to find clients for this service

— **Search terms:** on Maps and directories, look for businesses in categories where buyers do research first: "tour operator [city]", "consultancy Addis", "dental clinic [city]", "export [product]", "construction supplier".

— **Business types:** tour operators, consultancies, clinics, schools, exporters, engineering and construction suppliers, freight forwarders, training centres.

— **The filter that finds buyers:** businesses that have a social page but no website link in the bio, and businesses whose email address is a free mail account while they describe themselves as serving international clients.

— **Directories:** the online business directory at `https://www.an online business directory.com/directory` covers professional services, import and export, factories and construction, which is exactly the buyer list for this service. The an online business directory at `https://businessguide.ezega.com/` lists counts by category and filters by fourteen cities.

— **Regional advantage:** in a regional city, a regional city, a regional city or a regional city, a competent supplier with no website is common. Your competition is not other freelancers, it is the owner's belief that a website is only for big companies.

Outreach script

COPY-READY: FIRST MESSAGE, WEBSITE SETUP

Selam [owner's name], I am [your name]. I build simple websites for [business type] in [city].

I noticed [business name] has no website link anywhere — when a client abroad or an institution wants to check you, there is nothing to send them.

I built a demonstration page for you using information that is already public, so you can see the shape of it: [link]. It is a sample, clearly labelled, and I will take it down if you prefer.

A single page like that is [example price] USD and it is live within ten days. If you want it kept updated afterwards, that is [example price] USD a month. Would a short call this week be useful?

Delivery workflow, step by step

1. **Take the deposit before you start**

   Fifty per cent up front, fifty per cent when the site goes live. State it in the first written message so there is no surprise later.

2. **Interview for forty minutes, record it**

   Ask four questions: what do you sell, who buys it, why do they choose you, and what do you want more of. Ask permission before recording.

3. **Write the text before you touch the builder**

   Six short sections: who you are, what you do, who you serve, three services, proof, and how to contact you. Send it to the client for correction. Text first, design second.

4. **Collect and prepare photographs**

   Six to twelve images, compressed, named clearly. If the client has none, photograph on one visit. Never use a photograph from the internet, even a nice one.

1. **Build, then test on a weak connection**

   Open the site on your own phone with mobile data, not café Wi-Fi. Check that it loads in a few seconds, that the phone number is tappable, and that the map points to the right door.

2. **Hand over ownership properly**

   Make the client the owner of the account, or give them the login, and record it in writing. Then show them how to change one line of text themselves.

1. **Offer monthly care at handover**
   Prices change, hours change, the client gets a new photograph, a link breaks. One hour a month at an agreed fee is straightforward to justify on the day you hand over.

The upsell

Content: writing the service pages properly, adding a page per service, or producing the photographs the site needs. After that, the listing and the site reinforce each other, so offer Google Business Profile upkeep on the same visit. Further out, the biggest upsell is a catalogue or product page if the client starts selling online.

The recurring-revenue path

Monthly care is a small but reliable retainer, and it is honest: websites do need checking. Sell it at handover, when the client is pleased, not three months later. Five care clients at $12 a month is a base that keeps working while you look for the next project.

EXAMPLE SCENARIO — FICTIONAL

Client: Eastside Motors, a spare-parts and vehicle-service business near Kality, your city. Fictional.

Situation: The business has a Facebook page with 3,000 followers, no website, and loses enquiries because fleet managers want to see a proper company before they call.

What you sell: a Starter page at $8,000. You interview the owner, write six sections, photograph the workshop on one visit, and the page is live in eight days with a WhatsApp button.

What happens next: one month later you offer monthly care at $12, and a Google Maps clean-up because the listing shows an old address. He may take one, both or neither.

Invented for teaching. Nothing is guaranteed.

EXPLAIN A small business website is a credibility document, not a shop. It must load fast, say what the business does, and make contact effortless.

SHOW A tour operator in a regional city with a one-page site — three tour descriptions, six photographs, a map, a tappable phone number and a WhatsApp button — can send one link to a foreign enquiry instead of five separate messages.

DO Build one complete sample site for an invented business this week, on a free subdomain, and label it clearly as a sample at the top and bottom of the page.

CHECK It loads on mobile data in a few seconds, no photograph is stolen, every link works, and you can hand ownership to the client in under five minutes.

5.3 How these two feed each other

A listing without a page sends customers to a phone number and nothing else. A page without a listing is invisible to people searching nearby. Sold together they answer the two questions a customer has: **can I find you, and can I trust you.**

BUNDLE	WHAT THE CLIENT GETS	EXAMPLE PRICE
Found and trusted	Maps fix-up, twelve photographs, one-page site	$9,500 one-off

BUNDLE	WHAT THE CLIENT GETS	EXAMPLE PRICE
Found and trusted, kept current	The above plus monthly listing upkeep and site care	$22/month after setup

Example prices for teaching only. Sell one service first; offer the bundle after the first delivery.

06

SECTION SIX

Services Six and Seven: Catalogues and Customer Support

Two services that remove daily pain from a business: a catalogue that lets the owner answer "how much is this?" once instead of fifty times a day, and a messaging setup that stops orders from disappearing into an unread inbox. Both are delivered mostly from a phone, and both are sold to businesses that already sell through messages.

01 Service 6: Product and catalog digitisation

02 Service 7: WhatsApp and Telegram customer-support setup

03 The support-and-catalogue combination

These two services are the most natural to explain to an owner who sells through DMs, because the owner already knows the exact sentence they repeat all day: "I will send you the price."

6.1 Service six: product and catalog digitisation

Photographing a business's products and building a clean, priced catalogue — a document or image set the owner can send to any customer in one tap.

Who buys it

Furniture workshops and showrooms, clothing and shoe shops, electronics and phone-accessory shops, spare-parts dealers, ceramics and pottery sellers, cosmetics wholesalers, spice and grain wholesalers, and any business whose products change price often. The best buyers are wholesale and semi-wholesale businesses where one customer asks about thirty items at once.

The problem it solves, in the client's own terms

"Every customer asks the price and I type the same list again." "I send five photographs and they still ask for the size." "My prices changed and the old catalogue is still being forwarded." The owner is losing hours a day to repetition, and worse, is sending out-of-date prices that create arguments.

Beginner skill you need, and how long to learn it

Three skills, all learnable in **one to two weeks**: taking a clean product photograph in daylight against a plain background, keeping a tidy spreadsheet with consistent columns, and exporting a readable document or image set. No design talent is required. This is mostly organisation, which is why it suits patient people more than creative ones.

Free tools

— Your phone camera, used beside a window with a plain wall or a white cloth as the background

— Google Sheets for the master price list: item code, name, size, colour, price, availability

— A free design tool or document tool for the catalogue layout

— A free image compressor, because thirty uncompressed photographs will not send on a weak connection

Sample offer, written as a package

> **THE OFFER YOU CAN READ OUT LOUD**
>
> **I photograph up to thirty of your products on one visit, build a clean price list with item codes, and give you both a document you can send to any customer and a set of images you can post.** I keep the master list in a spreadsheet so that when a price changes, you tell me one number and I update everything in a day. You own the files; I keep a working copy so future updates take minutes, not days.

Sample pricing in USD

LEVEL	WHAT IS INCLUDED	EXAMPLE PRICE
Starter	30 products photographed and priced, one document, one image set	$19 one-off
Standard	100 products, item codes, categories, print and screen versions	$7,000 one-off

LEVEL	WHAT IS INCLUDED	EXAMPLE PRICE
Monthly updates	Price changes and up to 20 new products a month	$19/month

Example prices only, for teaching. Price your own work after timing the first thirty products properly.

How to find clients for this service

— **Search terms:** on Maps and in classifieds, search "furniture [area]", "spare parts [area]", "electronics [area]", "wholesale [product]".

— **Neighbourhoods and places:** furniture and workshop rows, spare-parts streets, electronics shopping buildings, and wholesale markets. In your city, Merkato and the areas around Kality and Megenagna; in a regional city the Franko area; and the main market street in almost every other city.

— **Business types:** furniture makers, ceramic and pottery sellers, clothing wholesalers, shoe shops, phone-accessory shops, spare-parts dealers, cosmetics wholesalers, spice and grain sellers.

— **Classifieds as a prospect source:** a local classifieds site at `https://jiji.com.et/` is full of live listings with prices and photographs. Find the sellers whose photographs are unusable — bad light, cluttered background, no size, no price — and that list is your market.

— **Regional advantage:** wholesale businesses in a regional city, a regional city, a regional city and a regional city often send customers a handwritten list photographed at an angle. You can fix that in one week of work.

Outreach script

COPY-READY: FIRST MESSAGE, CATALOGUE WORK

Selam [owner's name], I am [your name]. I build product catalogues for [business type] in [area].

I saw your listings on [a local classifieds site / your page]. When a customer asks for thirty prices, I imagine you type them one by one. I made one page of a sample catalogue using your public photographs and prices so you can see what it would look like: [image].

Done properly — thirty products photographed, coded and priced, as a document you can forward in one tap — it is [example price] USD. After that, updating prices takes a day, not a week.

May I come and photograph for one hour so you can see the first ten finished before you pay anything?

NEVER PHOTOGRAPH OR PRICE ANYTHING YOU WERE NOT GIVEN PERMISSION TO USE

Sample catalogues built from a business's public photographs are fine as a labelled demonstration. Photographing inside a shop without the owner's agreement, or copying a competitor's price list, is not. Ask first, always.

Delivery workflow, step by step

1. **Agree the list before the visit**

   Ask the owner to have the thirty items set aside, with sizes and prices decided. Half the time in this job is lost waiting for someone to decide a price.

1. **Set up one small photographing corner**
   A table near a window, a plain wall or cloth behind, and the phone held steady. The same corner for every product is what makes a catalogue look professional.
1. **Photograph in a fixed order and write the code as you go**
   Item code, three angles, one close-up of the label or detail. Write the code in the spreadsheet immediately, because you will not remember which photograph was which tomorrow.
1. **Confirm every price with the owner in writing**
   Send the spreadsheet for confirmation before you build anything. A wrong price in a catalogue the owner forwards to fifty customers is a serious problem, and it will be blamed on you.
2. **Build two outputs, not one**
   A document for sending to customers, and a folder of compressed images the owner can post. Most clients need both and will ask for the second one eventually.
3. **Deliver, then teach the update rule**
   Show the owner the one line to message you when a price changes. A client who knows the update path is a client who stays for months.

The upsell

Monthly updates, then a larger catalogue, then a simple product page or online ordering flow once the client sees how often the catalogue is forwarded. Later, the strongest upsell is lead generation: a catalogue plus a researched list of buyers is a much bigger service than either alone.

The recurring-revenue path

Prices change, stock changes, new products arrive. Sell the monthly update on the day you deliver: a fixed fee covering price changes and a set number of new products. It is one of the most dependable retainers to justify because the client feels the pain every time a price changes.

EXAMPLE SCENARIO — FICTIONAL

Client: Merkato Furniture Works, a family furniture workshop and showroom. Fictional.

Situation: The owner has about ninety items. When a customer asks for prices, he photographs a handwritten list and sends it at an angle. Prices changed three months ago and old lists are still circulating.

What you sell: a Standard package at $7,000 — 100 products, item codes, categories, print and screen versions. You photograph over two visits and confirm every price in writing before building.

What happens next: when a price changes two months later, he messages you one line. You update the catalogue for the monthly fee. He may decide to keep updating it himself instead, which is also a fine outcome.

Example only. This business does not exist.

EXPLAIN You are not selling photographs. You are selling an end to repetition and a single accurate list that everyone can trust.

SHOW A spare-parts dealer who answers forty price questions a day now forwards one document. The customer picks the part, and the dealer only discusses availability.

DO Build a ten-item sample catalogue for an invented business, with codes, prices and consistent photographs, and label it clearly as a sample.

CHECK Every photograph uses the same background and angle, every price has been confirmed by a second reading, and the whole document sends in under 5 MB.

6.2 Service seven: WhatsApp and Telegram customer-support setup

Setting up a business messaging channel properly: a business profile, a catalogue, quick replies, clear hours, a simple order flow, and a rule for what gets answered when.

Who buys it

Businesses that already take orders by message and lose some of them: restaurants and juice houses with delivery, bakeries taking advance orders, cosmetics and clothing sellers, clinics booking appointments, real estate agents, gyms selling memberships, and hotels answering availability questions. The buyer is an owner who has lost a sale because a message sat unread overnight.

The problem it solves, in the client's own terms

"I answer the same five questions all day." "Customers message at midnight and I see it in the morning." "Two people use this phone and sometimes both answer." "No one knows what we have." The cost is not abstract: an unanswered message is a customer who buys from someone else, and the owner usually cannot tell how many they lost.

Beginner skill you need, and how long to learn it

You need to understand how messaging apps work on Android, write clear short sentences, and be organised enough to build a consistent system. **One week of practice** is realistic: set up a test business account, build ten quick replies, and run a fake order conversation from first message to delivered. Entirely phone work. Check the current features and free limits in the app yourself, because messaging platforms change what they offer often.

Free tools

— WhatsApp Business on the client's own number, or a separate business number

— Telegram, for channels, groups and a public contact point

— Google Docs for the written reply templates and the escalation rules

— Google Sheets for an order log, so nothing is lost in a chat history

Sample offer, written as a package

> **THE OFFER YOU CAN READ OUT LOUD**
>
> **I set up your business messaging properly: profile, hours, locations, a product or service list, twelve ready replies for your most common questions, one order template, and a written rule for who answers what and how fast.** I train whoever uses the phone for one hour, and I give you a one-page sheet to keep beside the counter. Then, if you want, I can run the messages for you.

Sample pricing in USD

LEVEL	WHAT IS INCLUDED	EXAMPLE PRICE
Setup	Profile, hours, list, twelve quick replies, order template, one-page sheet	$22 one-off
Setup plus training	The above plus a one-hour training session for up to three people	$35 one-off
Managed support	You answer messages during agreed hours, log orders, send a weekly summary	$16/month

Example prices only, for teaching. Managed support is a serious responsibility: only sell it when you can genuinely answer within the agreed hours.

How to find clients for this service

— **Search terms:** look for businesses advertising a phone number as their main ordering channel, and for pages whose captions end with "DM for price" or "call to order".

— **Business types:** food delivery kitchens, bakeries taking advance orders, cosmetics and clothing sellers, clinics, real estate agents, gyms, hotels, event decorators, tutoring centres taking registrations.

— **Where to look:** Telegram channels and groups in your city, Facebook pages with delivery posts, and a local classifieds site at `https://jiji.com.et/`, where sellers publish phone numbers and manage everything by chat.

— **The strongest signal:** a business that posts "we are closed" or "sorry for the late reply" more than once. That is an owner who knows they have a messaging problem.

— **Regional note:** outside your city, this service is often more valuable than a website, because the entire customer relationship already happens in a chat window.

Outreach script

COPY-READY: FIRST MESSAGE, MESSAGING SETUP

Selam [owner's name], I am [your name]. I set up business messaging for [business type] in [city].

I noticed your page says [exact thing you saw, e.g. "sorry for the late reply"]. That usually means orders are arriving faster than anyone can answer them.

What I do is small and specific: your profile, hours and list set up properly, twelve ready replies for the questions you answer every day, one order template, and a one-page rule sheet for whoever holds the phone. It is [example price] USD and it takes two days.

If you want, I can show you the twelve replies first so you can see whether they match how you talk to customers.

Delivery workflow, step by step

1. **Sit and read the last fifty conversations**
   Not to spy: to count. Write down the ten questions that appear most often. That list becomes your quick replies, and the owner will recognise it immediately.

2. **Set up the profile properly**
   Business name exactly as it appears on the licence or signboard, category, address with a map pin, opening hours, and a description in one plain sentence.

1. **Write twelve replies in the owner's voice**
   Greeting, hours, location, price question, availability, delivery, payment, complaint, wrong number, appointment, bulk order, and closing. Short sentences. No corporate language.
1. **Build one order template and one order log**
   Item, quantity, price, delivery address, time, payment method, status. Every order goes into the sheet, so a chat history is never the only record.
1. **Write the rule sheet and train the people who answer**
   Who replies, within how long, what they may promise, what must go to the owner, and what to do outside hours. Print it and stick it near the counter.
2. **Test it with three real conversations**
   Ask three friends to send a question, an order and a complaint. Time the responses. Fix whatever broke.
3. **Offer managed support only if you can hold the hours**
   If you promise replies between 09:00 and 18:00, you must be available between 09:00 and 18:00. This is the one service in the book where a missed commitment is visible to the client's customers.

The upsell

Managed support, then the catalogue service, because a setup with no product list is half finished. After that, the natural next offers are social-media management and a Google Maps clean-up, since the same customers arrive through all three doors.

The recurring-revenue path

Support is inherently monthly, but it costs you daily attention. Price it accordingly and set the hours in writing. If managed support is too heavy, sell a smaller retainer instead: a monthly review, updated replies, and a fresh order log, with the client's own staff doing the replying.

EXAMPLE SCENARIO — FICTIONAL

Client: Wubit Bakery, a bakery in a regional city taking advance orders for birthdays and holidays. Fictional.

Situation: Two family members share one phone. The same questions — price per kilo, delivery, how far in advance to order — are typed out dozens of times a day. Twice last month, orders were written on paper and lost.

What you sell: Setup plus training at $35. You read fifty conversations, build twelve replies and one order template, start an order log, and train three people for one hour with a printed rule sheet.

What happens next: two weeks later you review the log with the owner and offer managed support at $16 a month. She may prefer to keep it in the family, which is a legitimate answer.

Invented for teaching.

EXPLAIN Customer support is a system, not good intentions. Replies, hours, escalation and a written order record are what stop sales from disappearing.

SHOW A cosmetics seller answers "how much?" fifteen times a day. With a product list and a quick reply, the answer becomes one tap, and the seller's attention goes to the customers who are actually ready to buy.

DO Set up a test business messaging account and write twelve replies for an invented business. Time how long it takes you. That number is your delivery estimate.

CHECK The owner has read every reply aloud and approved it, the rule sheet is printed and visible, and three test conversations have been answered inside the agreed time.

6.3 The support-and-catalogue combination

These two belong together. A catalogue without a support setup means customers still ask the same questions. A support setup without a catalogue means you have twelve replies that all say "let me check the price". Sold as one job, the client gets a channel they can hand to a member of staff and forget about.

BUNDLE	WHAT THE CLIENT GETS	EXAMPLE PRICE
Selling through chat	Messaging setup, twelve replies, order log, 30-product catalogue, training	$9,500 one-off
Kept current	The above plus catalogue updates and monthly support review	$28/month

Example prices for teaching only. Do not sell the bundle before you have delivered one of the two services at least once.

A HARD LIMIT ON MANAGED SUPPORT

Never promise reply times you cannot hold, and never let a client's customers believe they are talking to a staff member if they are talking to you. If the client wants you to answer as the business, agree in writing how you introduce yourself and what you are allowed to promise on price and delivery.

07

SECTION SEVEN

Services Eight and Nine: Writing, and AI-Assisted Documents

Words are the cheapest service to start and the hardest to fake. Service eight is writing the text a business needs in English or the local language. Service nine uses AI to draft the documents a business bids and sells with, corrected and verified by you. Both pay well relative to the time they take, and both are sold to clients who are applying for something.

01 Service 8: Content writing

02 Service 9: AI-assisted business documentation

03 Rules that keep AI-assisted work honest

If your English is strong and your the local language is correct, you already own the most underpriced skill in this book. Most small small local businesses cannot write a clear paragraph about themselves, and they know it.

WHY WRITING PAYS BETTER THAN IT LOOKS

Writing has no material cost, no rendering time and no file sizes. The work is thinking and typing. Two hours of careful writing can be sold for the same price as a full day of photography, provided you sell it as a business document rather than as "some writing".

7.1 Service eight: content writing

Captions, product descriptions, service pages, company descriptions, blog posts and simple newsletters, written in English or the local language or both.

Who buys it

Guest houses and lodges that need descriptions for booking platforms, tour operators writing itineraries, clinics explaining services, private schools writing about their programmes, consultancies and exporters writing company profiles, and any business whose captions are one line long and say nothing. The strongest buyer is a business applying to something: a booking platform, a tender, a partner, an association.

The problem it solves, in the client's own terms

"I know what we do but I cannot write it." "The foreign client did not understand our email." "Our page has not been updated in a year because I do not know what to say." The owner is not short of information. They are short of the confidence and the hours to turn it into clean text, and they know that badly written English costs them credibility with exactly the customers they want.

Beginner skill you need, and how long to learn it

You need clean grammar in at least one language, the ability to interview someone and pull out the useful detail, and the discipline to write short sentences. You do not need to be a novelist. **Two weeks of daily practice** is enough to start charging: write ten captions, three service descriptions and one company profile for invented businesses, then ask a harsh reader to mark them. Writing is phone-friendly for short pieces; long documents are much better on a laptop.

NEVER INVENT A FACT FOR A CLIENT

If the client says they have been in business for "a long time", you ask for the year. If they claim to be the biggest, you either confirm it or write it differently. **A number you invented on a client's behalf can cost them a contract and you a reputation.** Write "established in [year confirmed by the client]" or leave the claim out.

Free tools

— Google Docs for drafts, comments and version history

— A notes app on your phone for capturing what the owner says during a walk-through

— A free AI chat tool, where available, for structure suggestions and for checking your own English

— A plain text file of the client's confirmed facts, so you never write from memory

Sample offer, written as a package

THE OFFER YOU CAN READ OUT LOUD

Eight pieces of writing a month: captions, product descriptions or short posts, in English and the local language, based on a forty-minute conversation with you each month. You get the text in a document you can copy from, plus a short note explaining where each piece should be used. If a text needs a fact I do not have, I will ask you instead of inventing it.

Sample pricing in USD

LEVEL	WHAT IS INCLUDED	EXAMPLE PRICE
Starter	4 short pieces a month, one language	$16/month
Standard	8 pieces a month in English and the local language, plus suggested captions	$35/month
Project work	Company profile, service pages or platform descriptions as a fixed job	3,000 to $8,000
Single piece	One description or caption set	500 to $6

Example prices only, for teaching. Writing rates where you live vary enormously and no verified published rate card exists.

How to find clients for this service

— **Search terms:** look for businesses in categories where text sells: guest houses on booking platforms, tour operators, clinics, schools, exporters, consultancies, training centres.

— **The strongest filter:** businesses whose public text is clearly written by someone in a hurry — captions of three words, descriptions copied from a supplier, an English paragraph with obvious errors, or a page that has not been updated in a year.

— **Neighbourhoods and cities:** guest houses cluster near lake shores and airports; tour operators cluster in city centres; exporters and consultancies appear in the online business directory at `https://www.an online business directory.com/directory`, which lists more than ten thousand companies across import and export, professional services and factories.

— **Directory and association route:** the local Chamber of Commerce and Sectoral Associations lists around twelve chambers and six associations with phone numbers at `https://ethiopianchamber.com/our-members/`. This is not a prospect list, but it is a legitimate way to reach a group of businesses with one introduction.

— **Platform descriptions:** businesses listing on booking platforms often have a weak description they are unhappy with. That is a well-defined project with a clear before and after.

Outreach script

COPY-READY: FIRST MESSAGE, CONTENT WRITING

Selam [owner's name], I am [your name]. I write descriptions and page text for [business type] in [city].

I read your [page / listing] and I noticed [specific problem, e.g. the description never says what makes your rooms different]. I rewrote the first paragraph as a sample so you can compare: [text or link].

If you like the direction, I can do eight pieces a month — captions, descriptions and short posts — in English and the local language, from [example price] USD. If you only want the listing rewritten properly, that is a one-off at [example price] USD.

Delivery workflow, step by step

1. **Interview before you write a word**

   Forty minutes, recorded with permission. Ask: what do you sell, who buys it, why do they choose you, what do customers always ask, and what do you want more of.

2. **Build a fact sheet and get it confirmed**

   One page: year established, location, services, prices if published, qualifications, and anything the client is proud of. Send it back for confirmation before writing.

3. **Write the first piece and get a reaction fast**

   Send one piece of the eight before writing the rest. If the voice is wrong, you have lost twenty minutes instead of three hours.

4. **Keep sentences short and specific**

   Concrete nouns, real numbers confirmed by the client, no adjectives that mean nothing. Read every sentence out loud before you send it.

5. **Check the local language with a second reader**

   If you write the local language, have someone else read it before delivery. One misspelled word in a client's public text is worse than a plain sentence.

6. **Deliver as text, not as an image**

   A document the client can copy from is more useful than a picture of text. Add one line under each piece saying where it should be used.

7. **Reuse the fact sheet next month**

   Month two takes half the time because the facts are already confirmed. That time saving is exactly what justifies a monthly retainer.

The upsell

A company profile or a set of service pages as a project. After that, the documentation service in 7.2, which uses the same fact sheet and pays more per hour. Design is the third step, because good text deserves a clean layout.

The recurring-revenue path

Content is genuinely monthly: new products, new offers, new seasons, new reviews to quote. Sell the eight-piece retainer, not a single article, and keep the interview to one short conversation a month so the cost of serving the client stays low.

EXAMPLE SCENARIO — FICTIONAL

Client: Tana View Guest House, a twelve-room guest house in a regional city. Fictional.

Situation: The booking-platform description was copied from another property and still mentions a restaurant that closed. English captions are one line long.

What you sell: a Standard retainer at $35 a month — eight pieces in English and the local language, including a corrected description for each booking platform, using a fact sheet confirmed in writing.

What happens next: the owner sees the corrected description and asks for the same for two more platforms, which is project work on top of the retainer. Or she may decide one platform is enough.

Invented for teaching. No outcome is promised.

EXPLAIN Business writing is not literature. It is clarity about what a business sells, who buys it, and what to do next.

SHOW "We are a well-known and experienced tour operator providing best quality service" becomes "We run three-day tours from a regional city to a regional city for groups of up to six, with an English-speaking driver and a fixed price of [example]".

DO Find one weak public description in your city and rewrite three sentences of it as a labelled sample. That is your first outreach message for this service.

CHECK Every factual claim in your sample is either public, confirmed by the client, or removed. You have read the whole piece out loud once.

7.2 Service nine: AI-assisted business documentation

Using an AI chat tool to draft the documents a business needs — company profile, service list, proposals, quotation templates, staff checklists, simple manuals — then correcting, verifying and formatting them properly.

Who buys it

Businesses that sell to other businesses or to institutions: construction and engineering suppliers, importers, manufacturers, consultancies, training providers, freight forwarders, agro-dealers, and any business that answers tenders. The best buyer is one that has just lost an opportunity because its paperwork was weak, or one that bids regularly and writes everything from scratch each time.

The problem it solves, in the client's own terms

"We send the same information every time we bid." "Our profile is four years old and mentions a manager who left." "I need a quotation format that looks serious." "Every new employee is trained by being told things." The owner is losing hours to documents that should already exist, and losing credibility with exactly the buyers who pay the most.

Beginner skill you need, and how long to learn it

You need to be good at two things: asking an AI tool for a structured draft, and being a harsh editor of what comes back. The editing is the skill. Anybody can generate text; almost nobody checks it. **Two to four weeks of practice**, including using it for your own documents first. This service strongly prefers a laptop, because long documents are painful to edit on a phone.

THE FOUR RULES OF AI-ASSISTED CLIENT WORK

— **Never invent a fact.** No made-up years, staff numbers, project lists, certifications or client names, ever. If the client cannot confirm it, it does not go in.

— **Never paste confidential material into a tool you do not trust.** Client price lists, staff records, customer databases and tender documents are not yours to share.

— **Tell the client you use AI for drafting.** One sentence: "I draft with an AI tool and then correct and verify everything myself." Clients respect this far more than discovering it later.

— **You are responsible for the final document.** If it contains an error, "the AI wrote it" is not an answer. Read every line before it leaves your hands.

Free tools

— A free AI chat tool, where available in your area

— Google Docs for drafting, comments and tracked changes

— Google Sheets for quotation templates that calculate totals correctly

— A folder per client with their confirmed fact sheet, so every future document starts from truth

Sample offer, written as a package

THE OFFER YOU CAN READ OUT LOUD

A complete documentation starter pack: a two-page company profile, a one-page service list, a working quotation template, and two staff checklists for your most repeated tasks. I interview you once, you confirm every fact in writing, and I draft with an AI tool and then correct and verify the whole document myself. Two rounds of changes are included. You get editable files, so next year you change the date, not the document.

Sample pricing in USD

LEVEL	WHAT IS INCLUDED	EXAMPLE PRICE
Starter	Company profile plus a one-page service list	$19 one-off
Standard	Profile, service list, quotation template, two staff checklists	$40 one-off
Monthly	Updates, one new document a month, tender document assembly from existing material	$12/month
Per document	One document outside a package	1,500 to $19

Example prices only, for teaching. Tender and proposal work carries real risk: never promise that a document will win anything.

How to find clients for this service

— **Search terms:** on Maps and directories, look for "construction", "engineering", "supplier", "importer", "manufacturing", "consultancy", "training centre".

— **Business types:** building contractors, electrical and plumbing suppliers, furniture manufacturers, agro-dealers, freight forwarders, IT suppliers, training providers, NGOs and community organisations.
— **The strongest signal:** a business that advertises "we participate in tenders", or one whose public profile is a photograph of a business card, or one with a generic email address and no documents anywhere.
— **Directories:** the online business directory at `https://www.an online business directory.com/directory` lists import and export, professional services, factories and construction categories, which is precisely this buyer group. It also has a free "Add your Business" option, which means many listed companies have never had professional documents made.
— **Where not to look:** do not approach a business in the middle of a live tender with an offer to write it. Approach them between tenders, when they have time to think.

Outreach script

COPY-READY: FIRST MESSAGE, DOCUMENTATION

Selam [owner's name], I am [your name]. I prepare business documents — company profiles, service lists, quotation templates and staff checklists — for [business type] in [city].

Most of the businesses I meet rewrite the same information for every bid. I build it once, properly, in an editable file, so next time you change the date and the price instead of the whole document.

A starter pack is [example price] USD: a two-page profile, a service list and a quotation template. I draft with an AI tool and then correct and verify every line myself, and I will not put a single fact in that you have not confirmed in writing.

If it is useful, I can show you a sample profile for an invented company first, so you can judge the quality before you decide anything.

Delivery workflow, step by step

1. **Collect the truth first**
   One interview and one confirmed fact sheet: legal name, year established, location, ownership, services, equipment, staff numbers, qualifications, past projects the client is willing to name.
2. **Ask the AI for structure, not for facts**
   Use it to propose a section order and a plain-language style. Feed it only what the client confirmed, and never paste client-confidential material.
3. **Edit ruthlessly**
   Delete every sentence that could appear in any company's profile. Replace adjectives with specifics. Cut the length by a third if you can without losing information.
4. **Verify every number and name**
   Read the document with the fact sheet beside it and tick each claim. Anything unconfirmed is removed, not softened.
1. **Format for printing and for sending**
   Two versions: a clean PDF to send and an editable file for the client. Check that it opens on a phone, because that is where the client will first read it.

1. **Hand over the fact sheet too**
   Give the client the confirmed fact sheet as a separate document. It saves you work next time and it shows them exactly what was verified.
1. **Book the update**
   Documents go stale. Agree a date three months away for a review, and put it in your own calendar as well as theirs.

The upsell

Monthly updates and new documents. After that, the biggest step is assembling tender submissions from existing material — a higher-value service with real deadlines, which you should only take on once you have delivered two documents properly. Writing and design are the natural companions, because good documents need both.

The recurring-revenue path

Documentation recurs through review cycles: annual profiles, updated service lists, new quotation formats, new staff checklists as the team grows. A small monthly retainer covering updates and one new document is straightforward for a business to justify, because it replaces hours of the owner's own time.

EXAMPLE SCENARIO — FICTIONAL

Client: Debre Birhan Steel and Roofing, a small supplier and installer. Fictional.

Situation: The owner bids for supply work with a two-page document he updates by hand. It still lists an old workshop address and a project from 2021 that he cannot evidence.

What you sell: a Standard pack at $40 — profile, service list, quotation template and two staff checklists. The unverifiable 2021 project is removed rather than rewritten, and every remaining claim is confirmed on a signed fact sheet.

What happens next: with a clean quotation template, he asks for it to be updated monthly as prices move, at $12 a month. That is a possible outcome, not a promised one.

Invented for teaching.

EXPLAIN AI drafts; you verify. The client is paying for judgement, structure and accuracy, not for generated text.

SHOW A contractor's profile says "we are committed to quality and customer satisfaction". After your edit it says "we install roofing for warehouses of up to 2,000 square metres, with a two-year workmanship guarantee and a written quotation within three working days".

DO Write a one-page sample company profile for an invented business, clearly labelled as a sample, and highlight which parts a client would have to confirm before it could be used.

CHECK Every figure in the sample is either marked as something the client must confirm, or removed. Nothing confidential was pasted into any tool.

7.3 Rules that keep AI-assisted work honest

SITUATION	WHAT A BEGINNER DOES	WHAT YOU DO
The client cannot remember a date	Lets the AI fill in a plausible year	Writes "established in [year]" and asks again, or omits the line

SITUATION	WHAT A BEGINNER DOES	WHAT YOU DO
The client wants to look bigger	Adds staff numbers and offices that do not exist	Describes capacity and service area instead of inventing staff

SITUATION	WHAT A BEGINNER DOES	WHAT YOU DO
A tender document is shared	Pastes it into a free tool to summarise	Reads it and works from your own notes, or asks permission in writing

SITUATION	WHAT A BEGINNER DOES	WHAT YOU DO
The AI writes something confident and wrong	Sends it anyway	Verifies every claim against the fact sheet before it leaves your hands
The client asks whether you used AI	Denies it	Says yes, explains the verification process, and shows the fact sheet

These are working rules for a professional service, not legal advice. If a client has contractual confidentiality requirements, read them before you accept the work.

08

SECTION EIGHT

Service Ten, and the Systems That Hold Everything Together

Lead-generation assistance is the tenth service: building a researched list of potential customers for a business that sells to other businesses. Then this section builds the shared spine that every one of the ten services needs — one prospect sheet, one offer page, one delivery checklist, one client folder, one monthly report and one follow-up rhythm.

01 Service 10: Lead-generation assistance

02 The six systems every service needs

03 How the systems reduce your delivery time

Nine of the ten services make a business look better. The tenth makes it money directly, which is why it is often the most straightforward to justify and the hardest to deliver carelessly.

THE DIFFERENCE BETWEEN THIS AND A LEAD LIST YOU BUY

You are not selling a spreadsheet of phone numbers. You are selling **research**: the right businesses, the right contact person, a specific reason each one might buy, and a first message the client can send. A list without a reason is worth nothing.

8.1 Service ten: lead-generation assistance

Researching and building a list of potential customers for a business, with contact details, a note on why each one fits, and a first message ready to send.

Who buys it

Businesses that sell to other businesses or to institutions and have no idea who to approach: event venues and conference halls, training centres, gyms selling corporate memberships, B2B suppliers, printing shops, security companies, cleaning services, real estate agents, IT suppliers, and consultancies. The best buyer is a business whose owner says "we depend on word of mouth" and means it as a complaint.

The problem it solves, in the client's own terms

"I do not know who to call." "We only get customers when someone refers us." "I spend my evenings searching on my phone and find nothing." The owner is not lazy. They do not have a system for finding buyers, and they have never seen a list of two hundred qualified prospects with reasons attached.

Beginner skill you need, and how long to learn it

Systematic research and disciplined record keeping. That is the whole skill. If you can fill a spreadsheet consistently for three hours without skipping rows, you can do this. Give yourself **one week of practice** building two lists for invented clients. A phone works, but a list past fifty rows is much faster on a laptop.

WHERE LEAD GENERATION BECOMES A PROBLEM

Never build a list by scraping personal data, never sell a list to more than one client, and never message people on a client's behalf without the client's written agreement on the message. A list of businesses' public contact details is ordinary commercial research. A list of private individuals' phone numbers is not.

Free tools

— Google Maps for discovering businesses by category and area

— a local classifieds site at `https://jiji.com.et/` for live, priced listings by district

— The an online business directory at `https://businessguide.ezega.com/` for category counts and its fourteen-city filter

— The an online business directory at `https://www.an online business directory.com/directory` for larger companies across import and export, professional services, factories and construction

— Google Sheets for the list itself, with the same columns for every campaign

Sample offer, written as a package

THE OFFER YOU CAN READ OUT LOUD

Two hundred businesses that fit your customer profile, with the contact person where I can find one, a direct phone number or page, one specific reason each business might need you, and a first message written for each of the top fifty. Delivered as a spreadsheet you own, with a column for your own notes as you work through it. If a row is wrong, I replace it.

Sample pricing in USD

LEVEL	WHAT IS INCLUDED	EXAMPLE PRICE
Starter	50 qualified businesses with one reason each	$16 one-off
Standard	200 businesses, top 50 with a written first message	$35 one-off
Monthly research	100 new businesses a month plus replies tracking	$8,000/month

Example prices only, for teaching. A list nobody contacts is worth nothing, so price the follow-up work as well as the research.

How to find clients for this service

— **Search terms:** look for businesses whose customers are other businesses: "conference hall [city]", "training centre", "printing", "security service", "cleaning service", "office furniture", "IT support", "audit firm".

— **Business types:** event venues, training providers, corporate gyms, office suppliers, printers, security and cleaning companies, IT and software suppliers, consultancies, caterers, transport and logistics companies.

— **Neighbourhoods:** business districts rather than shopping streets. In your city, the commercial district, Kazanchis, the central district and around a national holiday Square. In regional cities, the area around the chamber of commerce office, the university and the main government offices.

— **Association route:** the local Chamber of Commerce and Sectoral Associations lists around twelve chambers and six associations with phone numbers at `https://ethiopianchamber.com/our-members/`. This is not a prospect list, but one association introduction can reach many member businesses at once.

— **A demonstration sells this service:** build a free sample of twenty rows for a business you want as a client, then send it. No explanation persuades as well as two hundred rows of research.

Outreach script

COPY-READY: FIRST MESSAGE, LEAD GENERATION

Selam [owner's name], I am [your name]. I build customer lists for [business type] in [city].

I made you a sample of twenty businesses that could realistically use [what the client sells], with a reason for each one and a phone number or page: [link].

This is the kind of work I do. A full list is two hundred businesses with a written first message for the best fifty, at [example price] USD. The sample is yours to keep either way.

If you want, tell me which ten of those twenty look most like your best customers, and I will build the rest around them.

Delivery workflow, step by step

1. **Define the customer profile in writing**

   Ask the client to describe their three best existing customers: type of business, size, location, what they bought. Get it written down and confirmed before you search for anything.

1. **Build the column structure once**

   Business name, type, area, contact person, phone or page, source, why they fit, approach status, next action date, notes. The same columns every time, so the client can use the sheet without training.

1. **Research in fixed blocks**

   Two hours on Maps, one hour on directories and classifieds, one hour verifying. Do not research for ten hours and verify for none.

2. **Verify before you deliver**

   Check that the phone number belongs to the business and that the business still exists. A list with dead numbers is a list the client stops using in week one.

1. **Write the first fifty messages**

   One short message per business, referring to something real about them. The client copies, edits the name and sends.

2. **Hand over with a usage sheet**

   One page: how many to contact per day, what to say if they reply, what to record, when to follow up. A list plus instructions is a service. A list alone is a file.

3. **Offer the monthly rhythm**

   Lists go stale and businesses get used up. Offer fresh research every month with the replies tracked in the same sheet.

The upsell

Reply handling: you take the responses and turn them into appointments. After that, the natural next services are a catalogue, a quotation template, or a messaging support setup, because a business with a list of two hundred prospects immediately needs something to send them.

The recurring-revenue path

Monthly research is a genuine retainer: one hundred new businesses a month, plus tracking which ones replied. It is also the most straightforward service to prove, because the client can count the rows and see the replies in the same sheet.

EXAMPLE SCENARIO — FICTIONAL

Client: a regional city Conference Hall, a small event venue in a regional city. Fictional.

Situation: The hall depends on walk-ins and one hotel that refers guests. The owner has never approached a company directly.

What you sell: a Standard list at $35 — two hundred businesses within reach, focused on companies that run trainings, plus a first message for the best fifty.

What happens next: the owner books two corporate trainings in the first month. Then he asks for monthly research at $8,000 to keep the pipeline full. Neither outcome is promised, and the number of bookings depends entirely on his own follow-up.

Invented for teaching.

EXPLAIN A qualified lead list is research with reasons. Volume without relevance wastes the client's time and destroys your reputation.

SHOW Instead of "200 companies in Addis", the list says: "Meskerem Trading, the commercial district, imports office supplies, fits because they run quarterly staff trainings for 15 people, contact: operations manager".

DO Build a twenty-row sample list for one invented client this week, with a reason in every row. Send it to one real business as a demonstration.

CHECK Every row has a business name, an area, a contact route, and a reason written in your own words rather than copied from their page.

8.2 The six systems every service needs

These systems are not administration. They are what makes the second month faster than the first, and what makes a service something you can hand to a helper later. Build them once and they serve all ten services.

SYSTEM	WHAT IT HOLDS	WHERE IT LIVES	WHAT IT SAVES YOU
Prospect sheet	Every business you have found, with the exact problem, the channel, the date contacted and the next follow-up date	One Google Sheet, one tab per city or campaign	Stops you re-approaching the same business and forgetting the ones who asked you to come back
Offer page	Your service, what is included, three price levels, delivery time and what you need from the client	One Google Doc, also saved as a plain text file on your phone	Makes every first reply consistent and saves you typing the same paragraph daily
Delivery checklist	The exact steps for your service, in order, from access to handover	One checklist per service, kept in the same folder	Stops you skipping the confirmation step that prevents most revisions
Client folder	Confirmed facts, approved text, final files, screenshots of what was delivered and when	One Drive folder per client, named with the month	Settles any dispute and makes month two take half the time
Monthly report	What you did, what changed, one recommendation, and the invoice	One Google Doc template you refill each month	This is the document that keeps a client paying, because it is the only place your work becomes visible
Follow-up rhythm	Day two, day seven, day twenty-one, then stop	Your phone calendar, with reminders	Recovers the clients beginners lose by sending one message and giving up

BUILD THE SYSTEMS ON DAY THREE, NOT MONTH THREE

Six small documents, made once, in about two hours. Everything after that is faster, and the difference between a freelancer and a small business is exactly this: a freelancer remembers, a business has a file.

EXPLAIN A system is any written step that produces the same result whether or not you are having a good day.

SHOW Without a delivery checklist you forget to confirm the client's price list in writing, and a wrong price goes out to fifty customers. With one, the confirmation step happens every time.

DO Create the six systems today using the delivery checklist from your chosen service chapter, and put the Drive and Sheet links on your phone home screen.

CHECK You can open your offer, your checklist and your prospect sheet in under ten seconds each, without searching.

09

SECTION NINE

Building the Business Around the Service

Pricing and raising prices, packages, the one-page scope document, onboarding, the client file, monthly reporting, invoicing and how money actually moves where you live, when to register and get a TIN, the tax basics, and the hard prohibitions that this course will not teach you to break.

01 The four questions that settle it in twenty minutes

02 Local clients versus international clients

03 The legitimate routes, in order

04 What never to do

05 Tax and registration, honestly

This is the section that turns a skill into a business. It is also the section most readers skip, and the reason many of them lose money they had already earned.

READ THIS BEFORE YOU TAKE A SINGLE DOLLARS

Payment routes, registration and tax all follow local rules that change. Everything here is a starting point for your own verification, not legal or tax advice. Confirm your own position with your national tax authority, your local district or district office, and your bank or wallet provider.

Getting Paid, Registration and Tax

This is the chapter that decides whether the rest of the book turns into money. It is also the chapter most online advice gets wrong, because most online advice assumes you live in a country with a full set of payment rails. If you do, the short version is at the end of this section. If you do not, the rest of this section is for you.

THE ONE RULE THAT PREVENTS ALMOST EVERY PROBLEM

Agree the payment route with the client before you agree the price. Not after the work is done, not in the invoice, not when they ask for your bank details. Before.

A client who cannot pay you the way you need is not a client. They are a conversation. Finding that out on delivery day is the most expensive lesson in this book, and it is entirely avoidable with one question asked early.

How money actually crosses a border

When a client in another country pays you, the money does not travel directly. It moves through a chain, and every link in that chain is a place where it can stop. Knowing the chain tells you which question to ask.

1. **The client pays something**
   A card, a PayPal balance, a bank transfer, a mobile wallet, a local payment method. What they can use depends on *their* country, not yours.

2. **A processor authorises it**
   Stripe, PayPal, Adyen, a regional gateway. This is where most cross-border problems originate, because processors operate country by country.

3. **A platform holds it**
   If you sell through a marketplace or course platform, they hold the money and pay you later, on their schedule, at their minimum.

4. **It is paid out to you**
   A bank deposit in your local currency, a PayPal transfer, or a wallet credit. **This is the link that fails most often**, and it is the one nobody checks before they start.

EXPLAIN Buyer-side and seller-side are independent. What your client can use to pay has nothing to do with what you can receive. A platform can be perfectly good for your buyers and completely useless for paying you.

SHOW *Example — fictional.* A writer in Nairobi sells a $25 template pack. Buyers pay by card without difficulty. The platform's payout page then shows one option: PayPal. The writer's PayPal account can send but cannot receive. Fourteen sales, $350, stuck behind a payout route that was never tested.

DO Before you build anything, open the payout settings of every platform you are considering and write down, in one sentence, exactly how money would reach your bank account.

CHECK Can you name the rail, the currency, the minimum payout and the delay? If any of those four is a guess, you have not finished checking.

The four questions that settle it in twenty minutes

Do this once per platform. It takes about twenty minutes and it prevents weeks of wasted work.

QUESTION	WHERE TO LOOK	WHAT A USABLE ANSWER LOOKS LIKE
1. Does this platform pay out to my country?	The platform's own payout-settings page or help article — never a blog post, never a YouTube video	Your country named on the platform's own list, with the payout currency
2. Through which rail?	The same page	A named method: local bank deposit, PayPal, Payoneer, wallet. "Contact support" is not an answer
3. What is the minimum and the delay?	The payout help article	A number and a schedule, so you can plan cash flow
4. What does it cost in total?	The pricing page *and* the fees help article — they often disagree	Platform fee plus processing fee, added together, expressed as a percentage of a typical sale

TWO RULES THAT WILL SAVE YOU MONEY

Read the payout page, not the signup page. Almost every platform lets you sign up from almost anywhere. That tells you nothing. The gate is payout.

Check whether two platforms share a rail. If two services both pay through the same underlying processor, they are not backups of each other. When that one rail has a problem, both stop at once. Verify the underlying rail, not just the brand on the front.

Local clients versus international clients

These are two different problems and they need two different answers. Do not let one delay the other.

	LOCAL CLIENTS	INTERNATIONAL CLIENTS
What works	Bank transfer, mobile wallet, cash, a local card gateway. Almost always available to an individual with no registered business.	A licensed remittance corridor, a platform that pays out to your country, or an employer's own payroll route.
Speed	Same day, often same hour	Days to weeks, depending on the platform's payout schedule

	LOCAL CLIENTS	INTERNATIONAL CLIENTS
What can block it	Nothing much, if you have an account in your own name	Country eligibility, missing documents, a rail that does not reach you

	LOCAL CLIENTS	INTERNATIONAL CLIENTS
Best first move	Start here. Local clients pay for your proof.	Test the payout route with a small real payment before you promise anything

THE TEST PAYMENT

Before you quote a single international client, run one small real transaction end to end: sell something cheap — a $5 template, a $10 review, a single small job — and take it all the way to money in your account.

This costs you one afternoon and one small fee. It converts every assumption in this chapter into a fact, and it is the single most useful hour in this entire book.

What to say to a client about payment

Clients are not suspicious of payment questions. They are suspicious of vague ones. Say the route plainly, in the first conversation, in writing.

COPY-READY: THE PAYMENT-ROUTING MESSAGE

Before we start, one practical thing so neither of us has a surprise at the end.

I am paid by **[route: bank transfer / a named platform / a licensed transfer service]**. The money arrives in **[currency]**, and I can start work as soon as the first payment shows on my side.

If you would rather use a different method, tell me now and I will check whether it works — I would rather spend five minutes on this today than a week on it later.

For **[amount]** the split is **[50]** % to start and **[50]** % on delivery.

COPY-READY: WHEN A PAYMENT IS LATE

Hello **[name]** — checking in on the **[amount]** for **[work]**, which I sent on **[date]**. It has not shown on my side yet.

Could you confirm the date it was sent and the reference number? If it has not gone out yet, no problem — just let me know when it will, and I will plan around that.

Pricing when the route costs money

Cross-border routes cost the sender or the receiver money. Decide who absorbs it before you quote, and put it in the price rather than discovering it later.

WORKED EXAMPLE — TARGET ARITHMETIC, NOT A FORECAST

```
Your price for the work: $100
```

```
Transfer or platform cost, if you absorb it: $5–$15
```

```
What actually reaches you: $85–$95
```

Two ways to handle it: quote a price that already includes the cost, or state plainly that transfer fees are the sender's. What you must not do is quote $100 and then argue about $12 after delivery.

NEVER DO THESE THINGS, WHATEVER ANYONE TELLS YOU

— **Never enter a false country, name or address** on a payment platform. It breaches the provider's terms, it usually fails identity verification anyway, and the consequence is a frozen balance and a closed account — with your customers refunded and your earnings gone.

— **Never use a relative's or friend's account abroad** to receive money that is yours. It is the same misrepresentation with extra steps, and it puts their account at risk too.

— **Never use a VPN to open a financial account** in a country you do not live in.

— **Never buy or rent a verified account.** The seller keeps access to it.

— **Never accept payment in a form your country restricts.** Several countries prohibit or restrict virtual-asset transactions; check your own before you accept anything unusual.

The published terms are unambiguous about this. Most platforms require you not to "create an account using a false identity or information, or on behalf of someone other than yourself", and prohibit misrepresenting your "identity, location or credentials". The stated remedy is suspension or termination, and where an underlying processor makes the final call it is often not appealable.

The legitimate routes, in the order worth trying

#	ROUTE	WHO IT SUITS	WHAT TO VERIFY FIRST
1	A platform that publishes your country on its own payout list, paying into a local bank account in local currency	Anyone selling digital products or courses	That the payout page offers *bank deposit*, not "PayPal only", for your country
2	A licensed money-transfer service (Western Union, MoneyGram, Remitly, WorldRemit and similar) for a one-off client payment	Freelancers and service sellers with a single client	That the receiving country and currency appear on the provider's own corridor list
3	An employer's own payroll or contractor route	Remote employees and long-term contractors	That the employer has paid a contractor in your country before — ask them directly
4	Registering as an exporter of services and receiving into a foreign-currency account	Anyone earning regularly from abroad	Your own country's rules. In several countries this unlocks full retention of foreign-currency earnings and an international card — ask a local accountant, do not guess

#	ROUTE	WHO IT SUITS	WHAT TO VERIFY FIRST
5	Trading through a properly registered company in the country where the payout account sits	Established sellers doing meaningful volume	Real incorporation, a real bank account there, real accounting, and any home-country approval required. Legitimate, but slow and expensive — not a shortcut

IF YOU ALREADY HAVE FULL PAYMENT RAILS

Then most of this chapter is not your constraint, and your fastest route is whatever your clients already use: Stripe, PayPal, a card gateway. Skim the four verification questions above anyway — the platform fee difference between two similar services is often several percentage points, and on a hundred sales a year that is real money.

Tax and registration, stated honestly

THIS IS NOT TAX ADVICE, AND THE RULES ARE LOCAL

Almost every country requires you to declare income you earn, and most require some form of tax registration once you are trading. What that means in practice — a tax number, a business registration, a turnover-tax threshold, a VAT threshold — differs enormously from country to country, and the thresholds change.

What to do: find your national tax authority's own website, look for the page on registering as a sole trader or self-employed person, and read the current threshold. If your earnings are small, you may be below every threshold. If they are not, register. A local accountant charges very little for one hour of advice, and that hour is worth more than any general guidance in a book written for the whole world.

Keep a simple record from your first sale: date, client, amount, currency, what it was for, and the fee deducted. That one sheet makes tax time trivial and makes you look professional if anyone ever asks.

IF YOU SELL THROUGH A MARKETPLACE, READ THIS

Large platforms are often the *merchant of record*, meaning they handle sales tax and VAT for the buyer and remit it themselves. That does not remove your obligation to declare the income you receive. It changes what you have to collect, not whether you have to report.

Some platforms also require a tax form before they will pay you at all — a W-9 if you are in the United States, a W-8 series form if you are not, or a local equivalent. If a form is required and not submitted, payouts are usually paused. Complete it early rather than after your first sale.

10

SECTION TEN

Scaling, and Your First Thirty Days

How one service becomes a small business: the second service, subcontracting to a friend, your first part-time helper, a portfolio that works while you sleep, productising, quarterly price increases, and the three numbers to track every month. Then the full Day 1 to Day 30 plan, each day with an objective, a task, an example, an output and a check.

01 The second service, and when to add it

02 Subcontracting and your first helper

03 Portfolio, case studies and productising

04 Raising prices every quarter

05 The three numbers to track

06 The Day 1 to Day 30 plan

Scaling does not mean getting bigger fast. It means removing yourself from the parts of the work that do not need you, one piece at a time, while keeping the quality that got you the client.

BEFORE YOU SCALE ANYTHING

You cannot delegate a service you have not delivered at least three times yourself, and you cannot raise a price you have never tested. The order is: deliver, repeat, document, then delegate.

10.1 The second service, and when to add it

Add a second service when the first one has evidence behind it: one client who has paid in two different months, or three clients who have each paid once. Then choose the second service by asking one question: **what does my existing client need next?**

FIRST SERVICE	NATURAL SECOND SERVICE	WHY IT FITS
Social-media management	Short-form video editing	You are already on site with a camera and you already know the menu or the product range
Canva design	Social-media management	You are already producing the images; posting them is the next step
Video editing	Social-media management	Video without posting is wasted footage, and the client knows it
Google Business Profile	Basic website setup	A customer who found the listing still needs somewhere to land
Website setup	Content writing	A site needs text; you have just interviewed the owner for it
Catalog digitisation	WhatsApp and Telegram support	A catalogue changes how customers ask questions, and the channel needs setting up
Messaging support	Catalog digitisation	A support setup with no product list is half finished
Content writing	AI-assisted documentation	The same fact sheet serves both, and the second pays more per hour
AI-assisted documentation	Content writing	Documents and ongoing content come from the same interview
Lead generation	Content writing or messaging support	A list of two hundred prospects needs something to send them

10.2 Subcontracting and your first helper

01 Subcontracting to a friend

You keep the client relationship and the price. A friend delivers one part — usually design or video. Agree in writing: what exactly they deliver, by when, what you pay, and what happens if it is late. **You remain responsible to the client**, so never subcontract the part you cannot check.

02 Your first part-time helper

Hire for the task you repeat most and enjoy least: photographing products, writing first drafts, filling the prospect sheet. Start with a fixed number of hours a week, a written checklist, and a trial of one month. Pay on time, in full, every time, or you will be hiring again next month.

03 What you must never delegate

Pricing, the scope conversation, confirming facts with the client, and the monthly report. These four things are your business. Delegating them is how a service business loses the thing that made it work.

04 The arithmetic that decides it

If you pay a helper less than the value of the hours you free up, subcontracting makes money. If you pay more, you are buying time, not profit, and you need to be honest about which one you are doing.

10.3 Portfolio, case studies and productising

A portfolio that works without you

— One Drive folder, view access on, one subfolder per piece.

— Every sample labelled **"Sample — created by [your name] for demonstration"**.

— Every real client piece used only with written permission, and never with their customer data visible.

— Three samples minimum, of the same client type you are targeting. Three cafés beat one café, one gym and one school.

— One page at the top of the folder explaining what you do, your three price levels and how to reach you.

Case studies in five lines

After each delivered job, write five lines while it is fresh: who the client type was, what the problem was, what you did, what changed, and one sentence from the client if they agreed. Five lines per client, kept in one document, becomes the most persuasive thing you own after six months.

Productising

Productising means turning your service into a fixed thing with a name, a scope and a price, so that selling it stops requiring a conversation about what it is. "The Found and Trusted setup: listing fixed, twelve photographs, one-page site, $9,500, ten days" is a product. "I do digital stuff, we can discuss" is not.

NOT PRODUCTISED	PRODUCTISED
"I can help with your page."	"The Page Starter: 4 posts a month and all messages answered, $25 a month."
"We can talk about prices."	"Three levels, printed on one page, the same for every client."
"It depends how long it takes."	"Ten days from the deposit, with two correction rounds."

10.4 Raising prices every quarter, and the three numbers

Review your prices on the first working day of every quarter. Ask three questions: how long did delivery actually take, how many clients said yes at this price, and what has happened to prices around me. If you said yes to everything for three months, you are too cheap.

1
CONVERSATIONS STARTED

2
CLIENTS CLOSED

3
RECURRING REVENUE

NUMBER	WHAT IT TELLS YOU	WHAT TO DO WHEN IT STALLS
Conversations started	Whether you are actually working on the business or only in it	Book two hours of outreach every day until the number moves. This is the number beginners let fall to zero first.
Clients closed	Whether your offer, your price or your proof needs work	If conversations are high and closes are zero, the offer or price is wrong. If both are high, raise the price.
Recurring revenue	The money that arrives next month without a new sale	Convert one existing client to a retainer before you look for a new one.

Track all three in one small sheet, one row per week. Three columns, ten seconds a day. Anything more elaborate is a way of avoiding the work.

10.5 The Day 1 to Day 30 plan

Ninety minutes a day. If you miss a day, do not restart; continue from where you stopped. The plan is written for a reader with a phone and no clients.

DAY 01 Choose the service

OBJECTIVE End the choice so you stop reading and start doing.

TASK Score the ten services on the six criteria in Section 01. Pick the highest scorer you could start this week.

EXAMPLE A reader scores content writing 26 out of 30 and Canva design 14, and chooses writing.

OUTPUT One written sentence: my service, my client type, my city.

CHECK ☐ You can say it out loud without reading

DAY 02 Name your skill gap

OBJECTIVE	Know exactly what to learn, in three written lines.
TASK	Make one sample of your service. Compare it with two examples you consider good. Write three specific gaps.
EXAMPLE	"My the local language caption has two spelling errors" is a gap. "Get better" is not.
OUTPUT	Three gaps and a practice plan for the next five days.
CHECK	☐ Each gap is an action you can complete ☐ None of them says "learn everything"

DAY 03 Build the six systems

OBJECTIVE	Have the folders, sheets and files ready before you need them.
TASK	Create Drive folders for Portfolio, Prospects, Clients and Templates. Build the prospect sheet with its nine columns. Write your offer page.
EXAMPLE	Prospect columns: name, type, area, phone, problem, channel, date contacted, follow-up date, status.
OUTPUT	Four folders, one sheet, one offer document.
CHECK	☐ All five open from your phone home screen in under ten seconds

DAY 04 Build sample one

OBJECTIVE	Have one piece of proof, properly labelled.
TASK	Create a sample for an invented café. Label it clearly and save it in the Portfolio folder.
EXAMPLE	"Sample — created by [your name] for demonstration. This business is fictional."
OUTPUT	One labelled sample in Drive.
CHECK	☐ The label is visible on the file itself, not only in the message

DAY 05 Build samples two and three

OBJECTIVE	Three samples for the same client type, so the pattern is obvious.
TASK	Make two more samples for invented businesses of the same type. Put all three in one folder and switch view access on.
EXAMPLE	A reader targeting guest houses makes three samples for three invented guest houses, not one of each business type.
OUTPUT	One portfolio link with three labelled samples.
CHECK	☐ The link opens for someone who is not signed in

DAY 06 Write the offer

OBJECTIVE One paragraph you can send to anyone, with a number in it.

TASK Write what you do, for whom, what is included, how long it takes, and what it costs as an example price.

EXAMPLE "Eight posts a month, replies to every message, one photo visit, $7,500, starting within three days."

OUTPUT The offer saved in your offer document and as plain text on your phone.

CHECK

- [ ] An owner would understand it in one reading
- [ ] It contains a quantity and a price

DAY 07 Set your price ladder

OBJECTIVE Three levels and a trial package, written down.

TASK Set Starter, Standard and Monthly Plus with your own numbers. Time your delivery so the lowest price still covers your hours.

EXAMPLE If Standard takes eight hours and you value an hour at $3, anything under $25 is not a business.

OUTPUT A one-page price ladder you can photograph and send.

CHECK

- [ ] Every level has a different scope, not only a different price

DAY 08 Build a prospect list on Maps

OBJECTIVE Twenty real businesses with a specific problem each.

TASK Search your client type plus your area on Google Maps. Open the first twenty results and write the exact problem you can see in each row.

EXAMPLE "Last post March 2026", "menu photo has no prices", "phone number is disconnected" — not "needs social media".

OUTPUT Twenty rows in the prospect sheet.

CHECK

- [ ] No row says "no page" without a reason you could repeat to the owner

DAY 09 Build a second list from directories

OBJECTIVE	Twenty more, found through directories and classifieds rather than Maps.
TASK	Work through a local classifieds site, the online business directory and the online business directory. Note where each business came from in the source column.
EXAMPLE	an online business directory lists restaurants and cafés among its categories and filters by fourteen cities, so a reader outside Addis can build a full list.
OUTPUT	Forty rows total, each with a source.
CHECK	☐ Every row has a phone number, a page, or a physical address you can visit

DAY 10 Qualify and prioritise

OBJECTIVE	A ranked top ten you will actually approach.
TASK	Sort by how quickly the problem can be fixed and how reachable the owner is. Move the top ten to their own tab.
EXAMPLE	A salon with a wrong phone number beats a hotel group with no marketing manager you can reach.
OUTPUT	Top ten with a screenshot or a note for each.
CHECK	☐ You could describe each problem in one sentence to the owner's face

DAY 11 Send the first five messages

OBJECTIVE	Start five real conversations.
TASK	Use the outreach script from your service chapter, edited so each message names the real problem you found.
EXAMPLE	"Your last post was in March and the menu has no prices" is specific. "I can help your business grow" is not.
OUTPUT	Five messages sent, logged with today's date.
CHECK	☐ No two messages are identical ☐ Each one ends with a low-pressure next step

DAY 12 Send five more

OBJECTIVE	Ten live conversations, which is the minimum useful sample.
TASK	Send five more, using the same method. Do not change the offer yet; you do not have enough replies to learn from.
EXAMPLE	A reader in a regional city targets ten gyms and salons within walking distance of her home.
OUTPUT	Ten rows marked "sent" with dates.
CHECK	☐ Each message was sent individually, not forwarded in a batch

DAY 13 First follow-up round

OBJECTIVE	Recover the conversations that went quiet.
TASK	Send the day-two follow-up to anyone who has not replied, with something new attached — a sample or an observation.
EXAMPLE	"I fixed the opening hours on a sample so you can see what I mean" adds something. "Any update?" adds nothing.
OUTPUT	Follow-ups logged with dates.
CHECK	☐ Every follow-up contains new information for the owner

DAY 14 Walk-in day

OBJECTIVE	Five face-to-face conversations in one afternoon.
TASK	Visit five businesses from your list between 14:00 and 16:00. Have your samples open on your phone before you walk in.
EXAMPLE	A café owner at 15:00 has time to talk. The same owner at 12:30 has a queue and no patience.
OUTPUT	Five visits logged with what you learned.
CHECK	☐ You left within five minutes whenever the owner was busy ☐ You asked for a specific time to return or send details

DAY 15 Phone day

OBJECTIVE	Ten calls, thirty seconds each, no rambling.
TASK	Call ten businesses with a published number. Say who you are, one reason for calling, and ask for a specific time to send details.
EXAMPLE	"I noticed your Maps listing shows an old number. May I send you a screenshot this afternoon?"
OUTPUT	Ten calls logged, with names of whoever answered.
CHECK	☐ You never spoke for more than a minute without the owner asking a question

DAY 16 Expand to sixty

OBJECTIVE Enough prospects to survive a bad week of replies.

TASK Add twenty more businesses. If you live outside your city, use the online business directory city filter and the online business directory to cover your own city properly.

EXAMPLE A reader in a regional city builds a full list of sixty without touching a single your city business.

OUTPUT Sixty rows, at least thirty with a specific problem noted.

CHECK

- [ ] You can reach at least fifty of the sixty by phone, message or a short walk

DAY 17 Second follow-up round

OBJECTIVE Follow up at day seven with proof rather than words.

TASK For everyone who has not replied in seven days, send one sample made for their business specifically.

EXAMPLE A redesigned version of their own poster, labelled as a sample, beats a paragraph about your experience.

OUTPUT At least five personalised samples sent.

CHECK

- [ ] Every sample is labelled as a sample
- [ ] You did not send the same file to everyone

DAY 18 Second walk-in day

OBJECTIVE Follow up in person with the five businesses you already visited.

TASK Return to the same five, plus five new ones. Remind them who you are and bring the sample you promised.

EXAMPLE "I said I would come back with the fixed poster" is a reason to be there. "Just checking in" is not.

OUTPUT Ten visits logged, with a clear yes, no or later for each.

CHECK

- [ ] Every "later" has a date attached
- [ ] Every "no" is recorded so you stop spending time there

DAY 19 Ten more messages

OBJECTIVE	Reach twenty-five live conversations by the end of the day.
TASK	Send ten fresh first messages from the list. Change one thing based on what you have learned: the opening line, the price, or the sample.
EXAMPLE	If nobody replied to a long message, send a three-line version instead.
OUTPUT	Twenty-five total approaches logged.
CHECK	☐ You changed exactly one variable, so you can tell what made a difference

DAY 20 Third follow-up, then close the file

OBJECTIVE	Finish the follow-up rhythm properly instead of nagging.
TASK	Send the final follow-up to anyone at day twenty-one. Say clearly it is the last message, leave your contact, and mark the row closed.
EXAMPLE	"I will not keep messaging you. If it becomes useful later, my number is here."
OUTPUT	A clean sheet: some conversations live, most closed.
CHECK	☐ Nobody has received more than three messages from you

DAY 21 Run your first real meeting

OBJECTIVE	Understand what the owner actually needs before quoting anything.
TASK	Ask four questions: what do you sell, who buys it, what do you want more of, and what do you currently pay for the closest thing to this.
EXAMPLE	The owner says the problem is that customers ask if they are still open. That is a listing and posting problem, not a video problem.
OUTPUT	Notes and one agreed next step with a date.
CHECK	☐ You quoted a range with a reason, not "it depends" ☐ You did not promise anything you cannot deliver

DAY 22 Scope document and deposit

OBJECTIVE	Turn a conversation into an agreement and a first payment.
TASK	Send the six-line scope confirmation. Ask for the deposit. Do not start paid work before it arrives.
EXAMPLE	Fifty per cent up front on a $35 job, balance on delivery. Sent as one message the same day you met.
OUTPUT	A written "confirmed" and a deposit received.
CHECK	☐ The scope names what is not included ☐ You wrote a receipt for the deposit

DAY 23 Deliver the first piece

OBJECTIVE	Prove you are reliable before you prove you are talented.
TASK	Deliver the first part of the work on or before the promised date, with a short message saying what it is and what you need next.
EXAMPLE	One sample post out of eight, delivered a day early, asking whether the style is right before you produce the rest.
OUTPUT	First delivery, sent before the deadline.
CHECK	☐ Every fact in the delivery was confirmed by the client first

DAY 24 Finish and hand over

OBJECTIVE	Complete the agreed scope and close the loop cleanly.
TASK	Deliver the full scope in one message with one folder link. Collect corrections in a single round, then send the final files.
EXAMPLE	One folder named with the month, one file per item, and a message listing exactly what is inside.
OUTPUT	Full delivery plus a written record of what was delivered and when.
CHECK	☐ You did not do extra work that was outside the scope for free

DAY 25 Ask for the retainer and a referral

OBJECTIVE	Convert one job into a monthly relationship.
TASK	At the moment the client is pleased, offer the monthly version of what you just did. Then ask whether they know one other owner with the same problem.
EXAMPLE	"This is the one-off version. The monthly version is the same work every month from $7,500, and it keeps the page alive."
OUTPUT	A yes, a no, or a "not yet" with a date.
CHECK	☐ You accepted the answer without arguing ☐ You never used the client's name anywhere without permission

DAY 26 Build the client file

OBJECTIVE	Make month two faster than month one.
TASK	Fill in the client file: business, owner, what you sold, price, dates, what they want more of, next action.
EXAMPLE	A confirmed fact sheet and the approved text means next month's work starts from truth, not from memory.
OUTPUT	One client file per client, in a Clients folder.
CHECK	☐ Anyone reading the file could take over the account without asking you a question

DAY 27 Build the monthly report template

OBJECTIVE	Have the document that keeps clients paying, ready to refill.
TASK	Build a five-line template: delivered, what changed, one number, one recommendation, invoice.
EXAMPLE	"8 posts published, 23 messages answered, best post reached more people than any post since March, recommend one video a week, invoice attached."
OUTPUT	One reusable report document.
CHECK	☐ You can refill and send it in under ten minutes

DAY 28 Invoice and collect

OBJECTIVE	Get paid without an awkward conversation.
TASK	Send the invoice message with your own wallet or bank details, a due date and a request for the confirmation. Write a receipt the same day.
EXAMPLE	Payment to your own name, never to an account belonging to somebody else.
OUTPUT	Money received, receipt written, income logged in your sheet.
CHECK	☐ Every dollars received is recorded with a date and a client name

DAY 29 Review your price and package

OBJECTIVE Correct the price you guessed thirty days ago.

TASK Measure how long delivery actually took. Compare it with what you charged. Set the price for your next client.

EXAMPLE Eight posts took eleven hours, so $7,500 was about $680 an hour. Your next standard price should be higher, or the scope smaller.

OUTPUT An updated one-page price ladder.

CHECK

- [ ] You know your own hourly number and you are willing to say it out loud

DAY 30 Review, and start the next twenty

OBJECTIVE Decide what continues, using numbers rather than mood.

TASK Count your three numbers: conversations started, clients closed, recurring revenue. Then write the next twenty prospects and send the first five messages today.

EXAMPLE Forty conversations, one client, $25 recurring. That is a real starting point, and the plan for month two is more conversations, not a new service.

OUTPUT A written month-two plan with the next twenty prospects listed.

CHECK

- [ ] You sent five messages before you closed the sheet
- [ ] You did not add a second service unless the first one has evidence behind it

WHAT THIRTY DAYS OF THIS ACTUALLY PRODUCES

A chosen service, three labelled samples, a written offer with three price levels, a prospect list of sixty real businesses, a logged outreach record, at least one delivered job, a client file, an invoice and a receipt, and three numbers you can repeat next month. **Not a guaranteed income.** Some readers will finish day thirty with one client. Some will finish with none and two warm conversations. Both are normal, and both are further than most people get.

CLOSING

Twelve Common Mistakes, and the Fix

These are the mistakes that cost beginners the most time. Most of them are not about skill. They are about sequence.

#	THE MISTAKE	THE FIX
1	Selling five services at once and becoming memorable for none	Sell one service to one client type in one city for thirty days. Add the second only after evidence.
2	Sending one message and stopping when there is no reply	Three touches over twenty-one days, each one adding something new. Then close the row and move on.

#	THE MISTAKE	THE FIX
3	Saying "it depends" when asked for a price	Give a range with a reason immediately, then narrow it once you know the scope.

#	THE MISTAKE	THE FIX
4	Lowering the price for the same scope	Remove work instead of discounting. A smaller package at a lower price, never the same package for less.

#	THE MISTAKE	THE FIX
5	Starting paid work before the deposit arrives	Send the scope confirmation, wait for "confirmed", wait for the deposit, then start.
6	Building a portfolio from real clients without permission	Use labelled samples until a client agrees in writing. Then show only what they approved.
7	Inventing a fact for a client's document or listing	Ask. If the client cannot confirm it, leave it out. One invented number can cost them a contract.

#	THE MISTAKE	THE FIX
8	Sending a 40 MB file to someone on a small bundle	Compress everything. Export video at 720p. Deliver by cable or memory card when the deadline is tight.
9	Doing free work for relatives and friends forever	Give one free sample, then quote normally. "Family price" means a smaller scope, not unpaid labour.
10	Never sending a monthly report	Five lines on the same day every month, before the invoice. This is the single biggest reason clients stay.
11	Keeping no record of what was delivered and when	One Drive folder per client per month, with a receipt for every payment.
12	Renting, buying or borrowing an account, licence or TIN	Do not. Use your own wallet or bank account, and register when the work justifies it.
13	Never raising prices while inflation runs	Review quarterly, give thirty days' notice in writing, and add something small at the same time.
14	Believing that one bad month means the business failed	More than eighty per cent of federal business licences issued went dormant during 2025. Clients disappearing is a planning assumption, not a verdict on you.

CLOSING

Questions Readers Actually Ask

Do I need a business licence?

Not to start. You can take payment from local clients through a personal wallet or a bank transfer in your own name. You need a registered business, with a trade licence, TIN and Memorandum of Association, before a merchant gateway such as a local card-and-wallet gateway will onboard you. Register when a client or a gateway requires it, not before you have a paying client.

How do I price when I have no experience?

Ask what the client pays now for the closest thing they buy. Work out how many hours the job takes and what an hour is worth to you. Then quote an example price and correct it after three clients.

There is no published local rate card for these services, so anyone quoting you a confident market rate is guessing.

What if the client will not pay a deposit?

Offer to start with a smaller piece of work that you can deliver in two days and invoice immediately. If they still refuse to pay anything before delivery, treat that as information about how the rest of the relationship will go, and decide whether you want it.

How many clients can I handle alone?

It depends on the service, not on you. Time your delivery honestly: if one social-media client takes eleven hours a month, three of them already compete with a full-time job. Most beginners can carry three to five retainer clients before quality drops, and the correct answer is the number your own timing sheet gives you.

Which service is easiest to start?

Google Business Profile assistance, if you have no design or video skill at all. It is reading, typing, checking and patience, it is entirely phone work, and the before-and-after is visible to the owner in a screenshot. Lead-generation assistance is a close second if you are organised.

How do I find clients outside your city?

Use the same method, with local search terms: your city plus the client type. The an online business directory filters by fourteen cities, and the online business directory lists companies nationwide. In smaller cities, walk-ins and association introductions work better than direct messages, and there is usually less competition for the same service.

How do I get paid?

Local clients: a licensed mobile wallet or a bank transfer in your own name. Person-to-person wallet transfers on a Level 2 account are capped at $450 a day, with two-factor authentication required above $120. Merchant gateways need a registered business. Foreign clients: through your regulator-licensed remittance corridor. PayPal, Payoneer, Wise and Stripe are not verified as direct receiving rails for a resident of a country with limited payment access.

What if the business closes?

It happens often. Plan for it by never depending on one client, by keeping your prospect list alive, and by collecting your monthly fee in advance. If a client closes with work unfinished, keep the record, be gracious, and ask whether they know anyone else who needs you.

Do I need a laptop?

No. Eight of the ten services can be delivered end to end on a phone. Website setup, long documents and large catalogues are genuinely better on a laptop, and one hour in an internet café per job is usually enough.

Should I offer a free trial?

Offer one free sample to one business you have chosen, once. Not a free month, not free work for everyone who asks. A sample proves your quality. A free month proves only that you work for nothing.

How do I stop clients from leaving after one month?

Send the monthly report, on the same day every month, before the invoice. Most one-month clients leave because nobody showed them what they paid for. Add one recommendation each month so the client can see what the next month would improve.

What about tax?

A TIN is mandatory. Turnover tax under your country's turnover-tax rules is 2 per cent on goods sold locally and 10 per cent on other services, and if VAT applies, turnover tax does not. VAT is Proclamation No. 285/2002. Presumptive or Category C rules could not be verified for this course, so confirm your own position at your national tax authority or your local district or district office.

Will this work if I only have a phone and a small data bundle?

Yes, if you choose one of the eight phone-first services and keep your files small. Read offline, compress everything before sending, do your research in fixed blocks, and avoid the worst network hours, which are usually 16:00 to 24:00.

Is this a scam?

This course sells no opportunity, no franchise and no guaranteed income. It teaches a service you deliver yourself and invoice yourself. If anyone offers you a shortcut to clients, contracts or foreign payment accounts in exchange for money, read the next section before you pay them anything.

CLOSING

How to Spot a Fake Opportunity

Service businesses attract scammers, because the people doing this work are motivated, short of capital, and looking for a faster way in. Every scheme below targets exactly that.

THE SCHEME	HOW IT SOUNDS	WHAT IS REALLY HAPPENING
Business-opportunity seminar	"Learn how young locals earn in dollars. Seats are limited. Pay at the door."	You pay for motivation and a certificate. Nothing is delivered and no client is introduced.
Franchise or distributorship scheme	"Become our regional distributor. Pay for the starter kit."	The money is in the kit, not in the customers. Check whether any independent distributor exists whom you can call without the seller present.
"Guaranteed government contract" broker	"I have an inside connection. Pay a facilitation fee and the tender is yours."	Nobody can guarantee a government contract. A fee for a guaranteed award is either fraud or bribery, and both end badly for you.
A client who asks you to pay for materials first	"Buy the materials and I will pay you everything plus profit on delivery."	You fund their project and they vanish. Never pay for a client's materials from your own pocket. Deposits flow to you, not from you.

THE SCHEME	HOW IT SOUNDS	WHAT IS REALLY HAPPENING
Fake tenders	A document with official-looking letterheads, a tight deadline and a bid fee	The bid fee is the product. Verify the tender with the issuing organisation directly, using a number you found yourself, never one printed on their document.

THE SCHEME	HOW IT SOUNDS	WHAT IS REALLY HAPPENING
Someone offering to rent your name or account	"Just let us receive payments through your wallet, we will pay you a percentage."	You become responsible for money laundering and fraud you did not commit. Never rent, sell or lend your account, licence, TIN or identity.

THE SCHEME	HOW IT SOUNDS	WHAT IS REALLY HAPPENING
Requests for your ID or a one-time code	"To verify your account, send a photo of your ID and the code we just sent you."	That combination lets someone take over your account, your wallet or your identity.

THE TWO WARNINGS FROM THE YOUR CENTRAL BANK OR FINANCIAL REGULATOR

Impersonation fraud. The your regulator has warned publicly that fraudsters impersonate people on WhatsApp, Telegram, Facebook, email, SMS and fake phone calls to request urgent transfers. The warning sits under your regulator Proclamation 1359/2025 Article 6(28) and the your financial-consumer-protection rules. Report suspected fraud to `your regulator's complaint address` or by calling **6230**.

The Telegram account-takeover scam. local press documented a scheme in which scammers pose as Telegram security staff, harvest passwords and one-time codes, seize the account, and then message the victim's contacts asking for money. Your contacts trust the message because it appears to come from you.

Never share a one-time code with anyone. No legitimate platform, bank or wallet provider asks for it. Not in a message, not on a call, not to "confirm your identity".

The eight-point legitimacy checklist

- [ ] The organisation has a physical address you have visited or verified independently, not just a phone number.
- [ ] Its name appears in a register you can check yourself, such as a licence, a chamber listing or an official website you found without their help.
- [ ] Nobody has asked you for a one-time code, a password, or a photograph of your ID sent through a chat.
- [ ] Money flows to you for work you did, not from you for an opportunity you might get.
- [ ] No one has promised a guaranteed contract, a guaranteed income or a guaranteed number of clients.
- [ ] You can speak to at least two people who have used the service and were not introduced by the seller.
- [ ] The payment route is in your own name, through a licensed provider, and you can explain it to a bank teller without embarrassment.
- [ ] If it is urgent, secret, or depends on you paying today, it fails this checklist. Legitimate work survives a night of thinking.

Sources & Further Reading

Every platform figure in this book traces to one of the sources below, all checked in September 2026. Platform country lists, payout methods and fees change often — confirm anything you intend to rely on at the source itself.

1. Gumroad — pricing and fee structure — https://gumroad.com/pricing
2. Gumroad — getting paid, bank-payout country list and payout schedule — https://gumroad.com/help/article/13-getting-paid
3. Gumroad — fees in detail — https://gumroad.com/help/article/66-gumroads-fees
4. Gumroad — payout settings, identity documents and tax IDs — https://gumroad.com/help/article/260-your-payout-settings-page
5. Gumroad — account suspension and what causes it — https://gumroad.com/help/article/160-suspension
6. Gumroad — terms of service (identity, location and account rules) — https://gumroad.com/terms
7. Lemon Squeezy — supported countries for sellers — https://docs.lemonsqueezy.com/help/getting-started/supported-countries
8. Lemon Squeezy — W-8 and W-9 tax forms for non-US sellers — https://docs.lemonsqueezy.com/help/tax-forms/w8-w9-forms
9. Lemon Squeezy — pricing — https://www.lemonsqueezy.com/pricing
10. Stripe — cross-border payouts and supported regions — https://docs.stripe.com/connect/cross-border-payouts
11. IRS — About Form W-8BEN — https://www.irs.gov/forms-pubs/about-form-w-8-ben
12. IRS — United States income tax treaties A to Z — https://www.irs.gov/businesses/international-businesses/united-states-income-tax-treaties-a-to-z
13. Whop — payout methods and countries — https://docs.whop.com/manage-your-business/manage-payouts/payout-methods
14. Payhip — how sellers get paid — https://help.payhip.com/article/173-how-do-i-get-paid
15. Ko-fi — how creators get paid — https://help.ko-fi.com/hc/en-us/articles/115003980093-How-do-I-get-paid
16. Fungies — countries you can sell from — https://fungies.io/global-availability/
17. Telegram — Telegram Stars for digital goods — https://telegram.org/blog/telegram-stars
18. Google — Business Profile supported countries — https://support.google.com/business/answer/6270107
19. YouTube — Partner Program availability by country — https://support.google.com/youtube/answer/7101720
20. DataReportal — global digital statistics — https://datareportal.com/reports/digital-2026-global-overview-report
21. World Bank — World Development Indicators — https://databank.worldbank.org/source/world-development-indicators
22. International Labour Organization — ILOSTAT employment data — https://ilostat.ilo.org/
23. Internet Society — Internet shutdown and disruption reporting — https://www.internetsociety.org/
24. FATF — virtual asset and payment-service guidance by jurisdiction — https://www.fatf-gafi.org/

Where research could not verify a fact, this book says so in the text and tells you to check it yourself. Those gaps were left as gaps deliberately.

CLOSING

Final Checklist

Work through this before you decide the course is finished. If you cannot tick a line, the line tells you what to do next.

- [ ] I have chosen one service, in writing, and one client type.
- [ ] I scored the ten services and kept the sheet.
- [ ] I know the three price levels for my service, in dollars, with the scope of each written down.
- [ ] I have at least three samples, each labelled "Sample — created by [my name] for demonstration".
- [ ] My portfolio folder has view access switched on and opens for someone who is not signed in.
- [ ] I have a prospect sheet with at least sixty real businesses and a specific problem noted for at least thirty of them.
- [ ] I have sent at least twenty-five first messages, individually written.
- [ ] I have followed up three times, at day two, day seven and day twenty-one, and then stopped.
- [ ] I have made at least five walk-in visits during quiet hours.
- [ ] I have a one-page scope document with a "not included" line.
- [ ] I have asked for a deposit and received one, with a written receipt.
- [ ] I have delivered a complete job, on time, in one folder, with one message listing the contents.
- [ ] I have asked a satisfied client for a referral without pressuring them.
- [ ] I have offered a monthly version of my service to at least one client.
- [ ] I have a client file for every client, with dates, price and next action.
- [ ] I have a monthly report template and I have sent it at least once.
- [ ] I have invoiced through my own wallet or bank account, and written a receipt the same day.
- [ ] I have logged every dollars received, with date, client and purpose.
- [ ] I know the wallet limits that apply to my account and I have two-factor authentication switched on.
- [ ] I know that a TIN is mandatory and I know where my nearest registration office is.
- [ ] I have written down my three numbers: conversations started, clients closed, recurring revenue.
- [ ] I have reviewed my price after measuring how long delivery actually took.
- [ ] I have read the anti-scam section and I know I will never rent my account or share a one-time code.
- [ ] I have not faked my location, used crypto for payment, or used another person's account.
- [ ] I have a written plan for the next twenty prospects, and I have already sent the first five messages.

CLOSING

Final Challenge: Pitch 20 Local Businesses

This is the only exercise in the course that matters if you do nothing else. Twenty real businesses, approached properly, over ten days.

READ THIS BEFORE YOU START

Pitching twenty businesses does not guarantee you a client. Nothing does. What it guarantees is that you will have twenty real conversations' worth of information: what owners actually say, what they object to, what they already pay, and whether your offer is understandable. Most readers who do this get replies. Some get none. Both outcomes tell you what to change, and neither is a verdict on you.

The exact pitch sequence

1. **Days 1 and 2: build the list of twenty**

   Ten from Google Maps by searching your client type plus your area, and ten from a local classifieds site, the online business directory or the online business directory. For each one, write one specific problem you can see with your own eyes.

2. **Days 3 and 4: prepare two samples**

   Take the two simplest problems on your list and fix them as labelled samples. Do not make twenty samples. Two is enough to prove what you do.

3. **Day 5: send the first ten messages**

   Use the outreach script from your service chapter, edited so each message names the real problem. Send them one at a time, spread over the day, from your own account with your own name and photograph.

4. **Day 6: visit five in person**

   Between 14:00 and 16:00. Phone charged, samples open, five minutes maximum if the owner is busy.

5. **Day 7: call five and send the last five messages**

   Thirty seconds per call: who you are, one reason for calling, one request for a specific time to send details.

6. **Day 8: first follow-up**

   Day-two follow-up to everyone who has not replied, with a sample or an observation attached.

7. **Day 9: second follow-up and second visits**

   Return to the businesses you visited in person, bringing the sample you promised.

8. **Day 10: count and decide**

   Count replies, count meetings, count refusals. Then write one paragraph: what I will change about my message, my price and my sample. Send five more messages before you close the sheet.

The tracker

One row per business, nine columns. Fill it the same day, not at the end of the week.

COLUMN	WHAT GOES IN IT
Business name and area	Exactly as it appears on Maps or in the directory
Client type	Café, guest house, clinic, salon and so on
Contact route	Phone, page, or the physical address you can walk to

COLUMN	WHAT GOES IN IT
Specific problem	The thing you saw, in words you could repeat to the owner

COLUMN	WHAT GOES IN IT
Channel used	Message, walk-in or phone

COLUMN	WHAT GOES IN IT
Date first contacted	The day you sent or visited
Follow-up dates	Day two, day seven, day twenty-one
Status	Sent, replied, met, quoted, won, lost, closed
What I learned	One line: what they objected to, what they already pay, what they asked for

Score yourself on effort, not on outcomes

SCORE	WHAT IT MEANS
20 businesses built and 20 first messages sent	You did the work. Whatever the replies, you now have real information and a live list.
20 built, 10 sent	Half the work. Finish the other ten before you judge your offer.
Fewer than 20 built	The list is the bottleneck, not your skill. Spend one more evening on Maps and directories.
Sent but never followed up	You have left most of the value on the table. Follow-up is where a large share of replies come from.

Twenty approaches is a small sample. Judgements about your price, your message or your service need at least that many before they mean anything.

CLOSING

Next Steps

This course gave you the business model, ten services, the pricing, the payment rules and a thirty-day plan. Depth in the individual skills lives in the companion courses.

Course 04 — Social-Media Manager

If social-media management is your chosen service, go deeper: content planning, community management, growing a page, and handling clients who want to post every day. Read it before you take your second social-media client.

Course 05 — Design Depth

If design is your service, this is where the craft lives: layout rules, print-ready files, menus and price lists, and the design decisions that make a beginner's work look professional.

Course 03 — AI-Assisted Services

If documentation or writing is your service, this is the depth course. It covers the drafting, editing and verification discipline that service nine depends on.

Course 06 — Digital Products

Once your service business has a client or two, a digital product lets you sell the same knowledge twice: templates, guides, checklists. Read it after you have delivered your service at least three times, not before.

Course 10 — The 30-Day Build

The full thirty-day challenge, day by day, for readers who want the whole build in one place with a stricter structure and a daily checklist.

What to do this week

Pick your service, build three labelled samples, list twenty businesses with a specific problem each, and send the first five messages. That is the whole course in one week, and it is more than most readers do.

ONE LAST HONEST SENTENCE

Most readers of this book will not finish the thirty days, and the ones who do will mostly finish with one or two clients rather than ten. That is what a real small business looks like at the start. The work is unglamorous, the replies are slow, and the second month is calmer than the first. Start with twenty businesses and one service, and correct as you go.

GLOBAL EDITION · FIRST EDITION · SEPTEMBER 2026

The Online Service Business

10 Zero-to-Low-Cost Services You Can Sell to Local Businesses

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Read This Before You Pick a Service

The local Online Service Business — 10 Zero-to-Low-Cost Services You Can Sell to Local Businesses. First Edition · September 2026.

Publisher: NexKit your country Editorial Team. This course was researched, written and edited by the NexKit your country Editorial Team. It carries no individual author name and no personal credentials, because the value of the book is the method, not a personality.

Edition: First Edition · September 2026. Copyright in this edition rests with NexKit your country. Please do not redistribute the file. If a friend needs it, send them to the shop, not the PDF.

What this course is

A practical, your country-specific manual for turning one digital skill into a small service business that local businesses pay for month after month. It covers ten services, and for every one it tells you who buys it, the problem it solves, the beginner skill you need, the free tools, a sample offer, sample pricing in dollars, how to find clients, an outreach script, the delivery workflow, the upsell and the recurring-revenue path.

What this course is not

It is not a promise of clients or income. It is not a list of real local companies you can approach as customers, because every business in this book is invented. It does not guarantee that any particular local business will pay for any particular service, and it is not legal, tax or financial advice. More than eighty per cent of federal business licences issued where you live went dormant during 2025, so client churn is a real planning assumption, not a warning.

DISCLAIMER — READ THIS ONCE, PROPERLY

This course is **educational material only**. Nothing in it is a guarantee of income, and nothing in it is financial, legal or investment advice.

Every price in this book is an **example for teaching, not a market rate**. your country has no published rate card for these services, so the honest method is to ask local businesses what they currently pay, then price from your own hours and the value you create. Your first price will probably be wrong; the course shows you how to correct it after three clients.

All prices, rates and ladders shown in this book are **illustrative examples** for teaching. You are responsible for complying with local law, your tax obligations, the terms of service of any platform you use, and the requirements of any bank, wallet or payment provider you deal with. Rules, fees, limits and country availability change, sometimes quickly.

Where the underlying research could not verify a fact, this book says so and tells you to check it yourself. Those gaps were left as gaps deliberately.

DATES, CURRENCY AND EXAMPLES

All money in this course is US US dollars (USD), written as $25. Where a United States dollar figure appears it states its rate and its date on the same line.

Every business named anywhere in these pages is invented. Each is labelled **Example scenario — fictional**. No real, recognisable local company is presented as a client, a case study or a testimonial.

Every figure cited is current as of **September 2026** unless a different date is printed beside it. Source URLs for those figures appear in the **Sources & Further Reading** section at the back of the book.

BEFORE YOU RELY ON ANY OF THIS

Payment limits, wallet rules, tax thresholds and platform availability are the parts of this book most likely to go stale. Treat every number as a starting point for your own check, not as a substitute for it. Where this book names a rule, confirm the current version with the institution that made it.

1. Google Business Profile \u2014 supported countries — `https://support.google.com/business/answer/6270107`

Last updated: September 2026. Questions or corrections: use the contact address supplied with your purchase.

What is inside this course

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HOW TO WORK THROUGH THIS COURSE

Skim the section dividers first so you can see the whole route. Then work one section at a time and finish the **DO** tasks before moving to the next. The scripts, templates and checklists are meant to be copied, filled in and sent — not admired.